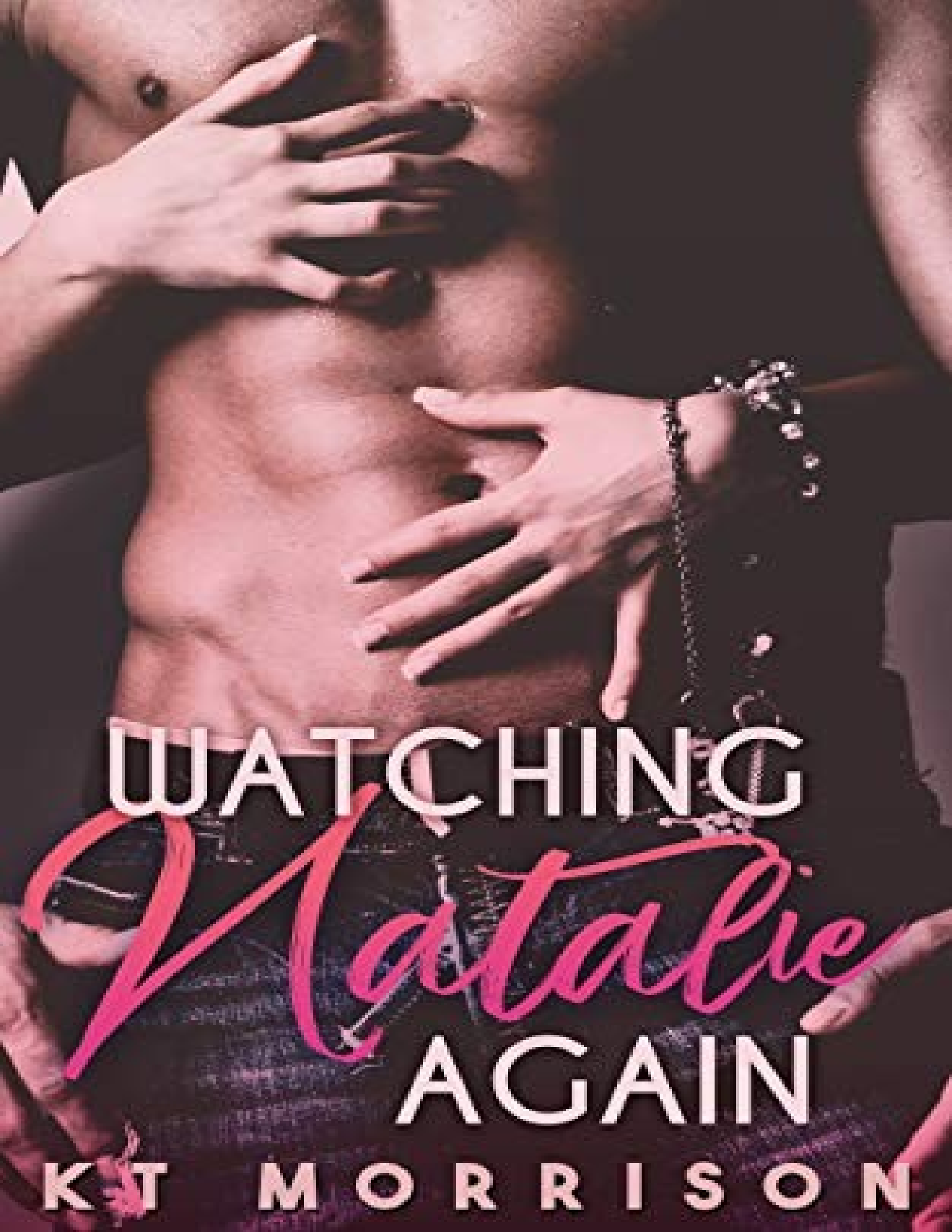




WATCHING

Matalie

AGAIN

KT MORRISON

Watching Natalie Again

KT Morrison

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About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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WATCHING NATALIE AGAIN

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Written by KT Morrison

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Chapter 1

Three months after Nelson watched his wife have wild sex with a man she hated, they went up north to camp and make maple syrup. Their marriage had never been better.

That was in the spring. It was maple syrup season, and they'd booked a weekend getaway together, coming up north and camping with strangers who were all married couples in the same age group, collecting sap during the day and boiling it down at nighttime, sitting under the stars and drinking beer and whiskey. They couldn't keep their hands off each other.

Ever since he secretly watched Natalie have sex with Renzo Bulgarelli in their kitchen, both of them couldn't stop professing their love for one another; in words and action. Natalie kept the deep, dark secret—or at least she thought she did—and she healed herself by renewed and energetic devotion to her husband. And he felt guilty for providing her the opportunity that wintry evening; prompting it and then watching—and he reciprocated with equally vociferous love.

So both of them had done terrible things to each other and kept it hidden. But for whatever reason, they were the strangest components of some arcane spell that turned their relationship to magic. They were inseparable. Christmas was amazing, both of them beaming and looking at each other with love. Even Natalie's sister made a gagging face at the table, fake-putting her finger in her mouth to make herself vomit over how 'lovey' the two of them were being. It got them both laughing—and didn't deter them in any way. It had been like that since then. Every night they'd sit on the couch and snuggle; he would hold her warm body in his arms and she would rub her cheek on his chest, maybe scratch his stomach...

And now it was a year almost to the day of that transgression. A dark and hurting moment in their life, but somehow worthy of celebration. That night

had changed them, and while it was an awful thing they had each done to the other, it had reinforced their love.

Nelson rented the sugar shack where they stayed in the spring. Mid-December, and they were both up north again, alone this time. A romantic weekend for two, camping out in a rustic cabin in the woods. No chores this time, no collecting sap and cooking it down, just snowshoeing and sitting by the fire and making out, maybe getting naked under the covers...



At the crest of the last hill before they returned to the sugar shack, Natalie stepped off the trail, pivoted and fell on her back, snow shoes sticking up in the air. She whomped into a soft pile of snow and it scattered around her ears; her heartbeat pounded up her neck.

Nelson's face slowly came into view, smiling under his sunglasses, his features a pale smudge rimmed with the fur trim of his parka. She could hear his snowshoes scrunching as he got closer.

She groaned, "I'm so out of shape."

Nelson laughed, stumbled toward her and fell to his knees. "Me too," he sighed. Now he patted her on the chest, said, "But you're doing good."

"I don't think I can make it."

He laughed again, pivoted and fell on his back right next to her. He said, "The cabin's like fifty feet away."

"You're going to have to carry me."

"You think that's the kind of shape I'm in?"

“Maybe you could drag me by my snowshoes.”

“You didn’t tie them up right, and I told you that. They’ll probably pop off and hit me in the face.”

“Why do you think I didn’t tie them up right?”

“You’re such a monkey,” he said, and now he was looming over top of her, the fabric of their parkas swishing against each other. He kissed her, and she blurted into his mouth as both their sunglasses bopped together and dug pain into the bridge of her nose. He laughed into her mouth too, pulled back and rubbed his nose. He took his sunglasses off, squinting and blinking, and she did the same.

“Come on, get up,” he said, tucking his sunglasses into his parka pocket and taking great care in getting to his snowshoe feet again. “Let’s go, I want to get drunk.”

“I am drunk,” she said.

“Nah, you probably burned it off with that hike.”

Nelson had made French toast on the old cookstove in the cabin, and they’d covered it in maple syrup and she used her special whiskey. Two-and-a-half hours of hiking through the bush would have sobered her up...

He extended a mitten hand out to her. “Come on, take my hand to help you up.”

She said, “No, it’s too late now. I’ve passed away. You’ll have to carry my corpse back.”

He said, “There’s no way I can carry you.”

Her brow lowered. “What does that mean?”

“Hey,” he laughed. “I mean I’m not that strong.”

She gave him a side-eye, not sure of her judgement yet, then brightened: “Look,” she said, and began flapping her arms and spreading her legs back and forth, snowshoes wagging in arcs. “I died, and now I’m a snow angel.”

“Ha ha,” he laughed then said, “Well fly your angel ass back to the cabin because I’m not helping you up...”



Together they stumbled into the sugar cabin, stomping their boots and clapping their arms around themselves to beat away the cold. The cabin’s cookstove was roaring hot, and the small space was well-insulated, so it was like walking into an oven. Once cold, they were both instantly too warm.

Nelson said to Natalie, still stuck in the door: “Get in, get in...”

“I’m coming,” she said, stumbling to get past him where he stood in the doorway.

He said, “Hurry, I want to close the door.”

“Hold on,” she said, kicking her heel up and twisting around. Her snowshoe strap had snagged on the button-snap of her snow pants’ cuff, and it was following her inside.

“You’re letting the heat out.”

“How about I let your heat out, you little monster,” she said, un-snagged the snowshoe and tossed it back outside with the others.

Exasperated, and gesturing to the unorganized clutter she’d left outside the snowy doorstep, he said, “Come on,” and it made her laugh.

Now he was outside again, taking her snowshoe, turning it point-side down and jabbing it into the snow so it would stand upright. When he turned around, she closed the door on him. Natalie regaled with great laughter behind the door.

He beat carefully at the glass inset with his fist. “Very funny, Natalie, it’s fucking cold out here.”

Through the glass, she was laughing. Unzipping her jacket, she said, “It’s almost too warm in here, Nelson. Do you have the fire too high?”

“Natalie, please. Just open the door.”

“Why don’t you go snowshoeing or something? Physical exercise might warm you up.”

“You’re such an idiot,” he laughed.

“I’ll tell you what. It’s so warm in here... if you take your things off, I’ll let you inside...”

Now he was smiling. “You take your things off.”

She frowned. “Nelson, you realize I’m the one with all the power here, right?”

“Fine, match me.”

“Match you what?”

He said, “Item for item. Take off what you want me to take off, and I’ll do it—when you take yours off...”

“Ooh, Sexy Nelson,” she crooned.

“Do it and hurry...”

With a scolding frown, she said, “It’s only going to get colder,” then did a little striptease, pushing her jacket off one shoulder, doing a quick shimmy

then pushing off the other shoulder. “You should probably talk nicer to me.”

“Come on,” he laughed, “hurry up. I want to have a drink and I want to sit down...”

“You get in here,” she said, “I don’t think you’re going to be sitting down.”

He folded his arms to send off a sense of authority as futile as it was. “I thought you died.”

“Nel-son’s go-ing to have sex with a gho-ost,” she sang, giving him a va-va-voom dance as she unzipped her snow pants.

“Are you serious?”

She stopped unzipping. “That you’re going to have sex with a ghost?”

“That I’m going to have sex.”

“Not with that attitude you’re not.”

He unzipped his jacket, showed her one shoulder—not giving it half the showmanship she did but at least mimicking her. Now he showed the other shoulder, took his jacket off. He was freezing.

Natalie wasn’t impressed. “And your snow pants...”

“You first.”

She drew the zipper of her snow pants down, dug her thumbs into the suspenders, knocked them off her shoulders then shimmied the pants down to her knees.

He did the same, taking off his snow pants while he watched Natalie inside, jumping around in a very unsexy manner, withdrawing her feet and boots from her snow pants, making them go inside out and almost falling flat on her face in the process. She jumped and hopped, banged against the door when she returned.

“Sexy,” he said.

She gave him a surly face, said, “I’m a just have a nap, buddy. Maybe put my feet up on the couch there.”

“What’s next?” he groaned.

She undid her fleece, waiting for him to catch up. They took their jackets off together and now he was just wearing a polyester shirt. She was as well.

“Take it off, buddy,” she said, and put her hands under the hem of her shirt and scrolled it up her body. Now she was standing there in black tights and a bra.

“Holy shit, Natalie. Please, let me in.”

“You have to be a good sport...”

He took his shirt off, and his skin instantly snapped tight with intense, biting cold.

She laughed. “Look how hard your nipples are.”

“Show me how hard your nipples are.”

She looked around the cabin as if someone might be watching though they were definitely alone around here. She pushed the point of her tongue against the corner of her mouth and rolled her eyes up as she unhooked her bra behind her back. Now she was running the bra straps off and showing him her bare breasts. They were large, teardrop shaped; tipped with blushing pink coasters.

“Hoochie mama,” he said and pretended to honk them through the glass. She laughed, got close to the glass and mashed her big soft girls up against it. “Oh shit, Natalie. You’re killing me. Please let me in...”

She was giggling now, breasts flattened against the glass and shaking her shoulders. He could see her nipples turn into hard bolts and push inward

against the softness of her breasts. With the tips of each one of his index fingers he tapped where they met the glass.

She said, "That feels good."

"You bet it feels good. Let me in..."

She said, "Why don't you put your pecker up against the glass..."

"Are you kidding me?"

She stepped back from the glass, cuddled her own breasts trying to bring warmth back to them. She said, "You think I'm joking, Nelson?"

Now it was him looking around even though they were alone in the woods; this could be embarrassing if someone discovered him. He pushed down his long-johns and showed her his half-hard dick.

"There's my little friend," she said.

"Fuck you, Natalie, it's cold out here."

"Where did your balls go?"

He tapped the tip of his dick against the glass.

She said, "Press it. Press it sideways, show it to me."

"It's cold, Natalie."

"Press it," she said firmly.

He pushed his hips to mash his penis against the glass for her amusement, and now she was tapping on him.

"You're right," he said, "that does feel good."

Natalie laughed, put both hands against the doorframe, her beautiful breasts hanging forward, and brought her face near the glass; she pressed her lips

flat to it. He pressed his lips to meet hers and touched cold flatness.

She drew out a long, cartoonish kissing sound, then bounced upright again. With a quick snap of her hand, the horizontal blinds clattered down between them and he heard her laughing in there.

He said, “Natalie, it’s not funny. It’s freezing. My dick is out...”

“Night Nelson. I’m going to drink all the rye.”

“Don’t,” he said. “Please let me in.”

“What are you going to do when you get in here?”

“Why don’t you open the door and you’ll see.”

“You’re supposed to bribe me to get the door open.”

“I’ll kiss your neck,” he said.

Her muffled voice: “What was that?”

He got close to the glass and cupped his hands around his mouth. “I said I’ll kiss your neck,” he said in a low vibrato.

“I’m listening,” he heard her say. A pop can opened.

“I’ll kiss your neck, and I’ll kiss those nipples.”

“You can do that.” He knew she was taking a drink. Probably having some of that rye, too. “What else do you want?”

“I don’t know. You tell me what I want. If it’s good enough, I’ll let you in.”

He rested his forehead on the cold glass. “I’m gonna bury my face between your legs.”

There was no answer.

“I’m gonna put my cold lips where you’re nice and warm.”

Still no answer. He tapped on the glass with his index finger. “Natalie?”

“I’m listening.”

“I’m going to use my tongue on you. I’m going to use my tongue on you until I can’t do it anymore.”

“Okay.”

“Will you let me in?” he said, making it low and sexy. “I want to use my mouth on you until the sun goes down.”

The lock clacked, and he opened the door...

Chapter 2

While that dummy who insisted they go snowshoeing was locked outside, she'd made a nest for them. Four wool blankets they'd packed were spread out over the questionable hygiene of the cabin's couch; she'd lined up maple syrup and Crown Royal, her bottle of 'single malt,' put pillows for their heads, unlaced her boots... oh, and got totally naked.

Nelson practically kicked the door in, stumbled into the cabin with his boots stomping, pants and long johns down his thighs, cock hard and upright. He slammed the door behind him.

She said, "Where have you been?" letting her bare foot bob where it lazily hung over the lip of the couch seat. Buck naked, hair sweaty but tousled sexily, she stretched a lazy, seductive line on the couch, up on one elbow and one leg draped over the other.

Nelson growled with comical anger.

She said, "Close that fucking door, you idiot, you crazy?—it's freezing out there..."

Nelson obeyed, coming in with a sly grin and closing the door behind him. He smiled, said, "Oh, I'm going to destroy you."

"That's my big talker. Let's see what you can do, tiger," she said and let her legs part, hiking one heel up to rest on the very top of the couch, exposing her hairy little lady to her husband.

"Jesus, Natalie," he said, "could you be any sexier?"

"I could, but then I'd have a husband who took me to Ibiza for Christmas."

"Oh really?" he asked, sauntering his way to the couch. "And this fictional husband, would he appease your whims?... Your moods, and your anger?"

She raised her eyebrows to a haughty height and said, "That tongue of yours is wagging, yet my pussy feels strangely dry..."

"I'd do anything for you," he said, giving her a dead serious eye that actually got her heart fluttering, "so fuck your Ibiza husband."

"Yeah, fuck that guy," she sighed, her hands grappling with her husband's shoulders as he lowered himself onto the couch and worked between her legs.

At the first touch of pleasure her husband's tongue delivered between her legs she moaned heartily, and her head rocked back. Out the window above the couch the sky was endless and blue, snowy gusts swirled; sun sparkled on the snow-laden evergreen boughs. Laying on the couch with her legs open she was warm and in love with her man; baking with the heat of the fire he'd stoked, cherishing the love den he'd brought her to out in the middle of the wilderness where it was just the two of them and no one else.

His warm wet tongue worked her well; her loving husband knew her weaknesses, knew where to find her pleasure. His head rocked between her thighs, and she sighed, "Wow, oh, Nelson, your ears are so cold." She closed her thighs around his ears and neck, let his ice cube auricles warm against her soft woman flesh while he made love to her with his tongue. Working up and down, swirling and pressing her button, darting the slightest tickle of penetration.

He let his mouth come free, kissing her pubic hair, looking up into her eyes. He said, "I'm going to suck on this hairy thing all afternoon..."

She laughed, sighed, "I don't need you to do it till sunset, Nelson, I just need you to do it right for four or five minutes."

Nelson laughed soft breaths against her sensitive membranes.

"Ah-hah, ah, that's nice," she said and ran her hands over his hair as he went back to work...



He did it right for five minutes. Natalie began whining and gasping, her legs tightened on his ears and she rocked from side to side, twisting his neck. He was good at this. Using his mouth on her had become his thing. He worked elasticity into her opening, stretching its ring of membranes, loving to produce her lubrication, loving to get her till she was dripping and overflowing. When she was fully engorged and hot to trot, her juices up his cheeks and running his chin, it reminded him of the Natalie he'd seen that night in the kitchen. The one that succumbed to their Lothario friend; the one she didn't even like. The one with the huge penis.

Now he had her hitching her breath, making high squeaks, her nails scratching at his scalp. She was so wet she smeared his mouth and face with her slippery sex. She came; squeezed his head so hard to keep him still. He knew the procedure: he stuck his tongue out like a pointed wet bud and rocked it against her clit, let her hump his face while she came...

Now it was his turn though, and he was so close. When Natalie was hot, when she was sexual, it cranked his motor so hot it glowed red. He was rock hard the whole time he ate her out, rock hard and leaking and dreaming of penetrating her.

He climbed her body while she still rode out his oral orgasm, Nat ready and wanting it even if her eyes were closed and she still made her coming noises. She opened her arms, spread her legs, and he lay over top of her. Her opening was easy to find and penetrate; she was wet and warm and her pussy swallowed his whole pipe in one easy stroke. She mewled in his ear, dragged nails on her back as he sunk himself home

"Oh, I love it," she cried, "I fucking love it, do it, Nelson, fuck me..."

He rocked his hips into her, swayed and danced and tried to keep his cool, but he was too close to the edge already. It wasn't a minute before he was

humping his ass up and down driving his steel rod in and out of her, stabbing into her hot wet pink, making her thrash and cry.

This was Nat at her finest. And there was nothing hotter than thinking of her as he'd seen her falling prey to their well-hung sexual predator friend with his sleeve tattoos and sexy smirk...

As his testicle's contents came to a roiling boil, he thought of her at her worst. Thought of her guilt, her hidden shame; thought of her stretched out and lubricated, Renny's huge cock reaming out her poor pink insides, leaving her sweet little canal devastated. What if Renny had come inside her? What would she feel like then? The guilt she would carry would be like a leaden weight.

God, he rode out that electric thrill and when he couldn't take it anymore and wanted the sweet release, he pinpointed a crucial tiny fold in time: A tumbling few seconds when he watched his loving wife get seduced sheerly by another man's size, tell that man she didn't want to have sex, change her mind, ask for a condom, get told he didn't have one, fucked him anyway. The most lurid and devastatingly erotic four seconds in Nelson's whole life. His wife's truth filleted like a caught fish on a dock, her insides bared and the awful—but wonderful—discovery that his wife was a disgusting, base, sexual animal. She could primp and preen, make lovey faces at her hubby, become an engineer, make six-figures a year, pamper her nieces with love and gifts, make the best banana bread in the world—but at her core was this dirty, hot and hungry snatch between her legs that could command her just as completely as Nelson's own cock commanded him.

And now he gritted his teeth and pounded her hole as hard as he could; and Natalie loved it. The excitement boiled up inside him and filled the cords and cables of sexual delivery; he growled and Natalie mewled.

“Harder, harder,” she whispered and gasped, her head rocking on the pillow, her calves squeezing his thighs. It was his trigger. Natalie wanting it harder, wanting what another man had given her; with the thought of his wife's desire for the large organ of their college friend she didn't even like, he exploded inside her, his cock flexing and bucking and Natalie humped against it, her insides milking him like a glove, rippling muscle stroking his

shaft in undulating waves as he pulsed stream after stream inside his beautiful woman.



Nelson's arms hugged her waist, his head squashing one breast over against the other; her legs wrapped his waist, and he had it so fucking hot in here their skin stuck together, making her ticklish with each breath they took. With the tip of a finger, she traced the shapes of his ear, enjoying the way it made him squirm.

"Quit it," he said, trying to protect his ear with his shoulder, but it only made her want to persist.

He was laughing, but the more she did it he finally clamped his teeth on some of her breast flesh and pretended to bite her.

"Ow, hey, all right, all right," she said slapping his cheek lightly. His bite turned to a kiss. She said, "Okay, why don't you get up... Maybe turn that fire down a bit..."

"It is hot in here."

"And pass me my drink."

Nelson eased himself off her, their skin coming apart and both of them making funny faces. Now he was over her naked, leaning one arm on the back of the couch to look out at the snowy landscape.

She said, "What's happening out there, buddy?"

"It's beautiful."

She said, “It’s a good spot. Magical. Thank you for bringing me here.”

He stroked her thigh and squeezed her knee. “You deserve it.”

“Work’s been so crazy...”

“You need a nice getaway.”

“I just like spending time with you,” she said and rubbed her thigh against his hip.

“Don’t get me started again,” he said, smiling at her now.

She eased herself forward so she could run her nails down his thigh. She saw his skin tighten with goosebumps—then she gave the head of his penis a little goose.

That got him moving, and she laughed and clapped as he clutched his genitals with both hands and got off the couch.

He said, “Don’t, I’m ticklish still.”

She watched him now as he pranced around their cabin naked. She cupped her own hands between her legs and could feel Nelson’s wet seeping out of her. “Throw me a towel.”

“Yeah,” he said, grabbing a fresh pair of underwear out of his overnight bag. He disappeared into the other room where they kept their toiletries. He returned with a towel for her, his underwear clutched between his legs.

She said, “Aren’t you gonna wash that thing down first?”

“What, and get your smell off me?”

“Don’t be gross, Nelson.”

“You’re gross.”

“Very mature. Hard to believe we’re adults.”

“Some of us like to maintain a youthful attitude,” he said, giving her a haughty, eyebrow-raised head shake.

“Wash your dick, Nelson. And then turn that fucking fire down,” she said, wiping herself with the towel.

“And you think you could get a husband that would take you to Ibiza.”

“I would probably be nice to him.”

“For a while,” he said and turned around to put his underpants on like he was shy. She sat up and whipped the towel at his butt and missed.

“Nice try,” he said.

She rested her elbows on her knees and her chin in the cups of her palms and watched her husband get dressed. She said, “You’re looking good, buddy.”

He brought his underpants up and let the waistband give a bright snap then slapped a buttock for her. “You like this?”

“The gym is paying off.”

“I’m glad you like it. I’m hitting it hard for your benefit.”

Now she sat back, slumped into the corner of the couch and looked down at her own naked body. She said, “I should probably go to the gym.”

He said, “You look beautiful already.”

“I know, but I was dying out there on the trail.”

“Natalie, you’ve never looked more beautiful.”

She ran her hands up her thighs, over her stomach, feeling herself.

“You like that body?” he said to her.

She squeezed her breasts together, said, “You like it?”

“You keep fondling your breasts like that, I going to have to take this underwear off again.”

“You didn’t wash your dick, did you?”

“Stop bugging me.”

“So you think you’re going to have sex with me again with that dirty thing?”

“You like it dirty,” he said then disappeared into the other room and she could hear him working the fire, opening the door and poking at it. Then the scissoring of the flue closing down.

She called out, “Can you bring me a wet wipe?”

“Sure,” he said from the cook room. This time when he returned, he had a bottle of Crown Royal he’d almost finished last night and a box of wet wipes. He threw himself down on the couch next to her. She popped the lid on the wet wipes, grabbed one and cleaned between her legs.

Nelson leaned forward to the coffee table and grabbed her Coke can. He poured Crown Royal into it. She waved him away, saying, “No, I’m on the single malt, I don’t want that,” then leaning back on the couch seat. She turned to look at him. She said, “Did you close that flue all the way down?”

“You don’t miss a thing.”

“I have ears.”

“I closed it down. I told you we’re going out for dinner.”

“You really want to? Don’t you want to stay here where it’s cozy?”

“You want me to make another Ready-To-Eat on the cookstove? Or you want a big greasy dinner?”

“Fine,” she said and threw her wadded up wet wipe onto the coffee table.

“It’s nothing fancy, believe me. But we’ll get something cooked in an oven, you know, or whatever. I wanna buy my hot little mama a hamburger.”

“French fries, too,” she said.

“Well get your shit together,” he said, “chop-chop.”

Chapter 3

It was tricky getting Natalie to agree to take two snowmobiles into town—how am I going to booze it up, Nelson?—but he began by insulting her snowmobiling skills and soon they had entered into a pretty serious challenge.

Night came early this time of year and they needed headlights as they raced the snow machines through the maple sugar property and out onto the trail network. Then it was a ten-minute neck-and-neck battle between them as they swooped and swerved their way through the woods as fast as the machines would go. When they neared the town of High Grove he let her get ahead and followed her winking red taillights through the snow in the wake of her machine. He let her win because he felt like the bigger victory was already his.

Natalie didn't see it that way, instead skidding her machine to a stop under the town welcome sign, then raising both fists over her head, and if their helmets had microphone headsets, he could imagine the taunting he would be hearing right now.

He cruised past her, smiling behind his black visor, and giving her a gloved middle finger. Natalie revved her machine and raced to catch up.

They came to a stop again in an armada of parked snowmobiles interspersed on the wintry hill leading up to an old log manor that had been converted into a restaurant. There were twinkling white strings of lights wound under the veranda and the posts and railings of its patio. Nobody sitting out there this time of year, but they could see the interior was packed.

Natalie took her helmet off, frowning and looking at the restaurant. "This place is hopping."

"Who would've known," he said, putting his helmet under his arm.

“Hope we can get a table.”

“I called ahead...”

They walked up together in their swishing snow suits, mounted the steps and beat the snow off their boots by stomping them. He held the door open for her, then saw a chalk sandwich board and hustled to get ahead to block it so she wouldn't see. Standing in front of it, he guided Natalie instead toward the sign in its stand that said, Please Wait To Be Seated. Along the opposite wall there were helmets and boots, even discarded snowsuits.

“Here, give me your helmet,” he said, then kept her eyes away from the sandwich board, dumped their helmets with dozens of others, hustled back to her as the Maître d' arrived, harried and struggling to smile. She asked them if they wanted a table, he told her they had reservations, and she ran her finger down an open iPad saying, “Stacks, Stacks... oh here it is.” She bundled up two menus and escorted them through the throng of people. The place was busy, every table taken, the clientele of a distinct rural country type, and they were led around the left side of the restaurant. The right-hand side was the bar, and he figured beyond that would be a dance floor and stage. The Maître d' brought them to a table for two at the very end of the dining room and he could see past the pool tables to where the stage was. He put Natalie's back to it and took the seat by the window telling her she had the better view.

Menus up, he asked her, “So what do you think? Hamburger?...”

Natalie smiled, said, “Oh yeah. Your baby wants a hamburger, fries, an app, and even dessert...”



Three bites into her warm brownie with vanilla ice cream on top and from behind her in the dance room a microphone whined with feedback. Mild applause followed, and she rolled her eyes for Nelson's benefit.

She swallowed, said, "Yee Haw."

Nelson laughed, took a bite of his apple pie, then covered his mouth with his hand to say: "How's your line dancing skills?"

"Rusty," she said, "but I'll follow your lead."

"Then we're in trouble," he said, still chewing.

Now there was the strum of acoustic guitar through an amp, a little twanging as their musical guest for the evening warmed his fingers up. Then the guy strummed his way right into a song without an introduction. A couple chords in, then some lyrics, and lo-and-behold it was a country song she actually knew.

Spoon of brownie and ice cream paused before her open mouth, she said, "Huh, Willie Nelson."

Nelson said, "Yeah," and took a bite of his pie.

The guy was a good singer, pretty convincing of emotion, a cool gravel sound in his rasp. When he got to the line 'Blue eyes crying in the rain,' he dragged the word 'rain' into a long lowing sound of sadness and her blood went cold. Her spoon dropped and clattered against her plate.

Nelson looked to her and she couldn't unfreeze the expression of horror on her face.

"Brain freeze?" Nelson asked.

She forced her chin to nod up and down.

When Nelson lowered his eyes to his pie again, she turned in her chair to look behind her.

“Oh, fucking no way,” she exhaled in a quiet moan.

On a stool center stage, one bright spot on him, Renny Bulgarelli strummed his guitar while a gaggle of drunken snowmobilers swayed and tried to sing along. Her view of him was in a narrow frame between the edge of a wall that closed off the bathrooms and the brick wall back of the bar. It was definitely him, sans band, going solo, black T-shirt, black jeans, hair up in a tall pompadour, a scarf wrapped around his neck.

Nelson caught her turning back around, saying, “You okay?” a look of concern on his face.

She gave that stiff head nod again, croaked, “Yep.”

“You don’t look okay. Too much to eat? Is it the single malt?”

“Unh-unh,” she said, shaking her head no. “I gotta go to the bathroom.” Then she was up, banging her knee on the table and spilling water over the lip of her glass. She crossed behind the bar, chin tucked down, hand up to block her face from Renny seeing her, but peeking out at him past her pinky. Oh, it was fucking definitely him, all right.

In the bathroom now she overheard two middle-aged women talking about how hot the singer was.

“Fuck off,” she sighed under her breath as she passed by them, heading to a stall and feeling woozy. Closed inside, back against the door, she saw the toilet had been left un-flushed. A skinny turd drew the green-brown curve of a question mark, bobbing just below the surface.

“Exactly,” she said to it. “What the fuck is happening here?”

Arm folded over her face, she breathed into the cotton crook of her elbow, leaned a leg way out and pushed the chrome lever down with the toe of her snow boot. At first coming in here she thought she might want to throw up a brownie and hamburger, but as stomach-turning as the sight of the dirty toilet had been, it seemed to cure her of the notion. Instead she had her

hands on her knees, face tucked into the open collar of her flannel shirt, staring at the tile floor.

“How is this even possible?” she said into her collar.

How was it possible they would come to eat dinner in snowy bum fuck nowhere and they would run into the guy she cheated on her husband with? The coincidence was staggering—and almost a year to the date, too. This was some kind of karmic punishment for her enormity.

The trick now would be to get the bill paid and get the fuck out of here before Nelson noticed Renny was here. That nice guy dummy she married would want to hang with him. God, imagine the three of them hanging out now?—Nelson joking around with his disgusting friend that didn’t stop Nelson’s wife from giving him a hand job. With Nelson sleeping only a few feet away. Her hands clawed at her cheeks from the memory. Renny came in her mouth. Then he followed her into the kitchen and poked that big thing up under her nightshirt. Then a minute later she’s doing the one thing she would never do and doing it with a guy she couldn’t even stand.

All right, all right, Natalie, get your shit together...

She’d been in here too long already. She could pee back at camp, throw up back at camp—the situation called for expediency not wallowing and self reflection.

Boot on the lever again, she gave the toilet another flush, clunked the door’s bolt and joined a clutch of women gathered around the sinks and mirrors.

Pretend-washing her hands, she stared at her dumb reflection in the mirror. Cheater. Slut. Terrible person. To do that to someone you love so dearly you had to be the worst person on earth. But what she’d done had served to reinforce her love for Nelson, shown her what he meant—and she’d re-dedicated herself to loving him even stronger. This last year between them had been astounding.

“You okay, sweetie?” A woman in a hooded sweatshirt and snow pants next to her, shooting her a look of concern.

“What, yeah, why?”

“You’re just staring. The water’s not even running anymore.”

“Huh?” Stupid motion sensing taps—she looked to see her soapy hands in the sink, nothing coming from the faucet. She waved both hands around to get it going again.

“Daydreaming about the singer?”

She showed the woman an abrupt face like she’d offered her shit on a spoon. “What? Him? No. He’s so gross...”

“Gross?” the woman said, and her fat friend at the sink on the other side of her laughed.

“He’s gross,” Natalie said to her own sad reflection.

The woman’s fat friend said, “Gross? Jesus, can’t wait to see your husband.”

The other one said, “She must be married to George Clooney.”

Natalie said, “I love my husband.”

“I love my husband too, honey, I’d be in that guy’s dressing room in a minute.”

The fat one said, “What Hank don’t know won’t hurt him.”

While they enjoyed their fantastic ribaldry, Natalie leaned closer to her reflection; looking cheek to cheek, then checking her teeth. Great—she had smudges of chocolate in the corners of her lips. She cleaned them away with warm water, checked her hair. Before they left this evening, Nelson helped braid her hair into two thick French pigtails that clung close to her neck. She should have worn it down, maybe put on some makeup.

Jesus, Natalie, are you fucking preening?

“Oh God,” she moaned into her hands pressed to her face.

She was as bad as the others in here: all of them touching up their middle-aged looks before they headed back in to see Mr. Dreamboat’s show.

Now she was hustling out, coming behind the bar, hiding her face from the stage again. The table was empty. Half a brownie on her plate swam in a growing puddle of vanilla ice cream. Nelson’s plate was cleared, his chair empty.

“Oh fuck, oh no,” she sighed, rested a palm over her hot forehead.

Behind her Renny sang Coal Miner’s Daughter, a strange gender choice, but he knew his audience: they were into it, swaying and humming along.

Women gathered near the front of the stage, her washroom friends weaving the crowd now to join them. That’s when she saw Nelson standing at the bar and waving to get her attention. He had his back to the stage, facing her, elbow on the bar’s padded edge, smiling away. And there together were her two present male problems: grinning, innocent husband, and looming over his shoulder his college roommate, perennial bad boy with an enormous penis. She had to get Nelson out of here.

She popped the collar on her flannel shirt like it might hide her face and crept her way to the bar while Nelson gave her a puzzled look. Joining him at the bar she gripped his arm above the elbow—she would physically stop him from turning around if she had to.

He got close, shouted near her ear: “Did you want to finish your brownie?”

She shouted back: “No, let’s get out of here. Did you pay?”

“Not yet.”

She fumbled for her credit card zipped with her ID in an inside pocket of the snow pants, saying, “It’s on me, buddy, I’ll pay, you go get the helmets, let’s get going.”

“Hold on...”

Credit card held up in one hand displayed to get the bartender's attention—hoping she could settle up with him and get out of here—near to Nelson's ear, she said, “Baby, let's get back, I want to have sex, okay?—Let's go back to the cabin and have sex again, okay, please...”

Nelson braced her, grabbing her upper arms and setting her back, angling her to see, and she tensed, knowing what was coming...

He shouted, “Nat, can you believe this?... Look, Renny's here...”

Chapter 4

The look of horror on Natalie's face was exquisite.

Now he said, "I mean, what are the odds?..."

Natalie had to pretend to be surprised; like she hadn't already seen Renny and had to scramble to the bathroom to recover. She peered beyond his shoulder and did this fake surprise-smile, said, "What? Really?"

"Isn't it crazy?"

The bartender was there but Natalie's credit card was down at her thigh as she stood dumbly staring at the guy she'd cheated on him with. He showed the bartender three fingers, saying, "Three shots of rye, but I want you to send one up to the singer, he's our buddy." The guy nodded and turned his back to draw down a bottle of Alberta Springs from a shelf.

Natalie was grabbing him now, fingers pinching hard on his upper arms. "No, come on, let's go, Nelson, let's go now."

"Oh, come on, Nat," he said, "what a crazy coincidence, we have to have a drink with him."

"Nelson, no, please..."

The pleading in her voice and the quiver in her eyes got him hard.

"One drink, Nat, please, don't be so mean..."

"Nelson, come on," she was saying and pulling on him to get him to walk, "it's just us this weekend."

"One drink, Nat, one drink..."

“Please, Nelson, please, I don’t want to see him...”

“Why not?”

The jab he’d just thrown her sent her brain tumbling protectively. She transitioned: “You know how I feel, Nelson... The wedding...?”

“But we had such a good time last year, remember?—It was almost an exact year ago.”

“Please, baby...”

Now her eyes grew wide, and he turned to see a waitress going up on stage with a single shot of whiskey on a serving tray. Renny was wrapping up Loretta Lynn, and the server had good timing, Renny nodding to her approach as the crowd applauded at the end of the song.

Rye presented to him, Renny took the glass, gaze following then where the server pointed toward the bar with her empty tray, both of them smiling. The waitress cupped her hand near his ear to whisper something. Renny slung his guitar to his hip, shielded his eyes from the spotlight glare.

“Well, look who it is,” he said into the microphone and raised his glass, “almost a year to the day.”

Natalie had gone ghost white, and he had to nudge her to take the shot glass from him. He got her eyes, trying to coordinate a mutual imbibing, but she was dumbfounded. Hand cupping her elbow, he encouraged her to bring the glass of rye to her lips and while he and Renny knocked their whiskey back in unison, Nat fumbled to set hers back on the bar.

Now Renny handed the empty glass back to the waitress who seemed to genuinely enjoy the idea that this cute singer had run into old friends. Guitar swung back in place, he jumped right into a catchy beat, bobbing his head and tapping one cowboy boot hooked over the stool’s bottom rail.

Though it was countrified Nelson recognized the song; Renny sang all about a bad girl, one who broke his heart and took all he had, and he how he

was going to get her back, then crooning the chorus, everyone recognizing it as Bruno Mars. He belted out 'Natalie,' like he really wanted to get revenge so bad she'd be begging Please, please, please.

It was more than Nelson could even have hoped for. He nudged her with an elbow like Hey, isn't this funny, he's singing you a song with your name in it, but secretly enjoying the despair on his wife's face. Not to hurt her, not at all. But just to know she was facing the awful and bottomlessly erotic thing she'd done. Right now that sweet little brain of hers was reluctantly playing back images; showing her, reminding her of how dirty sex with Renny and his big horse cock was.

Near the end of the song he picked up the tempo, lost the country and found some of the funk, then strummed into a quick and decisive end, slapping his hand over the strings to squash the song while everyone cheered. Renny laughed to himself until the gathered crowd died down and he leaned to the mic, eyes aimed toward the bar and said, "I'm just playing, Natalie, I ain't mad at you at all, girl."

Natalie's lips were pursed to a tight pucker, chin tucked into her neck. She looked like she was going to implode. Two women were watching her from the crowd, making faces at her now, a heavyset woman and another in a hooded sweatshirt. Natalie spun around, hung her head and put her elbows on the bar's cushioned rail.

"You all right?" he asked her and rubbed her back.

Natalie raised an index finger indicating one more shot to the bartender, and the guy hustled over right away. She had two shots of whisky in front of her now but wouldn't take them. He was dying from the pleasure thinking how this was twisting her up.

"Can we go now?" she said, voice hoarse.

"Come on, Nat. Don't be like that," he said and used both hands to rub and squeeze on her shoulders. He could feel the tightness and the tension in her.

She said, "Please, Nelson, I just want to go back to camp."

“You feeling all right?”

“I think I have diarrhea.”

He couldn’t help laughing.

She said, “What?” Getting mad.

“No, you don’t. Stop being a jerk. Remember last year how nice it was when he showed up? It was like old times. And look, this year we’re out doing something fun again—instead of lounging around in our PJs we’re out doing something.”

“Nelson, please, why aren’t you listening to me?”

“Why are you making such a big deal out of it? It’s just Renny.”

She moved her shoulders out of his grip, shrugged away from him and began sidestepping down the bar.

He asked her, “Where are you going?”

“I’m leaving. Don’t make me stay here and hang out with Renny. I wanted to have a weekend alone with you.”

He showed her both palms, said, “You’re being ridiculous. Just one drink then we’ll go back home.”

“Fine, Nelson. I’ll see you back at camp.”

He watched her now and had to stifle a smile; his guilty wife moving away from the bar and weaving through the crowd that was gathering to watch Renny sing. She took a left past the table where they ate and disappeared behind the bar, heading to the front door.

He set his butt up on the stool, leaned his back against the counter, put his elbows on the cushioned rail and watched Renny.



She made her way to the front door, poked around the gathered helmets, found hers, scooped it up, threw arms into her jacket and zipped it up. Now she was storming out the vestibule, going across the porch and thumping down the steps onto the snowy hill. Her heart was drumming in her chest. The backs of her arms and legs had gone weak, adrenaline coursing through her but now thinning and making her feel tired. She had to get out of there; the anxiety was overwhelming; it was crashing in roaring waves against her weakening retaining wall, knocking bricks loose and soon it would be up her lawn and devastating the wonderful home she and Nelson had built.

Passing between rows of snowmobiles, all of them just gleaming hunks of dumb plastic and metal all looking the same, she finally saw one with a visor she remembered. She set her butt down on its saddle, sat breathing heavily and trying to collect herself. Practically crying though no tears came, her breaths were heaving in ragged sobs.

What the fuck was wrong with Nelson? Why wouldn't he just leave with her? Couldn't he hear how badly she wanted to go?

Now she was thumping the helmet against her knees, getting mad. She poked her head inside it, wiggled it down, turned and straddled the snow machine. She was shoving hands in her outer pockets, putting one inside, unzipping, getting cold into her jacket when she fucking remembered...

Nelson took the keys. Right when they got inside, he took the helmet from her to put it away and held his hand out, waiting. She'd plopped the keys in his glove.

Fuck this.

Her hands were literally shaking. She held them outright now and even though she wore heavy gloves, she could see the trembling in the light

rimming them from the bar's patio.

Now she was pushing herself off the snow machine, marching between the rows of snowmobiles down the hill to the plowed edge of the road. She would just walk home. Fuck Nelson and fuck Renny. She pulled her helmet off and tucked it under her arm, stopping on the edge of the road, her feet striking the ground so hard her vision was warbling. She climbed the snowbank, scrambled down the other side, crossed the road and walked underneath the sign announcing the welcome to the town of High Grove.

With no benefit of headlights she was wandering in the dark. But it was snowing, and the trail was framed by towering conifers. It was enough for her to see her way home.

She'd gone maybe a kilometer before she realized how crazy this would look to Nelson. She was going to walk home? She was going to go probably ten to twelve clicks on foot in the middle of the night through the snow to a place she didn't even really know where it was? There were wolves out...

She was acting ridiculous. Worse than ridiculous, she was acting guilty.

She dropped to her knees in the middle of the trail, looked up to the stars. It was beginning to snow, she could feel fat flakes dropping onto her hot cheeks and melting. She took the helmet and beat it three times into the hard packed snowmobile treads, chipping up darts of snow. Why wouldn't Nelson just come home with her? Why was she showing Nelson the worst, most anxious side of herself? She was practically telling him what she'd done. What would he think when she didn't come back, and he got worried, got on his snow machine and had to come look for her? Would he even think to hit the trail first or would he call the police? Maybe some guys in a pickup truck had abducted her, he might think, thrown her in the back after they beat her over the head. He would freak out. Sure, he might catch up to her eventually on the trail and what would she say to him then? I was really serious about not seeing Renny. And he would say Why? And she would say You know I don't like him. And he would say You don't like him so much you would walk all the way home and leave me at the bar? You know how worried I was?...

“Fuck, fuck, fuck,” she said, dragging her legs out from under her and trying to stand. She turned around, looked back at the distance she’d already come.

She began to trudge her way back to the bar...



Renny performed a trifecta of country trucker music. First, he did Tennessee Ernie Ford’s ‘Sixteen Tons,’ then into ‘Convoy,’ which he folded into the Baker Street house favorite: ‘Take This Job And Shove It.’ A delight for sure, played for Nelson’s benefit, and also well received by the crowd. He applauded on the outro, and Renny winked then paused to take a drink of water.

It had been fifteen minutes since he’d last seen Natalie. Yes she was mad, but she wasn’t that mad. She was in debt to him and she wouldn’t do anything too crazy. She wouldn’t walk home. She was probably out sulking on her snowmobile, cursing him for taking her key.

Renny was tuning up again, adjusting the keys on the neck of his guitar and Nelson gave him a small wave before walking out to the restaurant side where there was no sign of Natalie.

He was only wearing his bib snow pants and a sweatshirt, but he stepped outside onto the porch in the freezing cold. Snow was coming down in soft fat flakes that drifted sideways. He could see out over the sea of snowmobiles. The two they rode in on still sitting there. Still no sign of Natalie.

From behind him: “Hey.”

He was smiling before he turned. Natalie was sitting on the bench seat by the front door facing out the same direction as him. Snow pants and boots, her down jacket zipped right up to her chin. She held the helmet in her lap like a baby.

He said, "Getting some fresh air?"

"Very funny, Nelson. Why are you being such a jerk to me?"

"I'm not being a jerk at all, Nat. You're being weird. We just ran into one of our good friends in the middle of nowhere and you're doing everything you can trying to claw your way out of here. What's got into you?"

She was sullen. "Nothing," she huffed.

"Then come on inside. He's probably only going to do a few more songs. Come in again, have another brownie. We'll sit and listen, then we'll just say hi, have a drink, and that's that. Okay?"

She didn't answer, leaning back heavily against the wall, her head lolling in the thick downy collar of her jacket. She wouldn't look at him, casting her gaze to the side and trying not to roll her eyes.

"Well?..."

"Fine," she said after a moment.

"There," he said, satisfied. "You want a brownie? Let's get another brownie and a couple coffees..."

She still wouldn't look at him, but she pushed out a hand for him to help her to stand. He grabbed her wrist with both hands and hoisted her up and put his arms around her.

He said, "Is there a reason you don't want to see Renny?"

He could feel her stiffen in his clutch. She said, "You know I don't like him."

“I know. We had a good time last year. Remember we were sitting around acting like nerds and he came back to remind us what it was like—”

She finished for him: “To be young.”

“Come on, Nat. Let me buy my baby another brownie with two scoops of ice cream.”

“Fine,” she said, but she still wouldn’t look at him.

“And you think I’m being a jerk...”

She sighed, “You are...”

He kissed her cold cheek, kissed his way to her lips.

She was reluctant, squirming a little, but soon he felt her arms circling his back and holding him, too.

Chapter 5

Renny sure had taken a downturn. Up there by himself, getting a little old for the musician act. No cute little hotties out in the crowd waiting to bang him after the show (although he could probably throw down with any one of the scores of middle-age snowmobilers here). That's what he had come down to. How sad. There was a time when his band had promise, a time when there was talk of record deals and hit songs. The radio station even put him on a digital compilation one year, and the band played their New Year's Eve event.

But now here he was, looking a little older and a little sadder. A little old to have full sleeve tattoos and such a cool haircut. And who was he singing too? A bunch of rural types up in the middle of nowhere. It suited him. He deserved it. In fact, she would tell him. She couldn't wait to tell him.

Nelson said, "How's your brownie?"

"Fine," she said, trying to hide the meanness in her voice. She loved Nelson but she couldn't help being mad at him right now. Couldn't he pick up on her vibe? Just go with it?

Now he asked her, "You want another cup of coffee?"

She nodded.

Nelson raised his hand and brought the waitress over. They weren't sitting at the same table but they were three down from it. She could see around the other side of the bar this time, most of the tables in the restaurant empty, the patrons gathering around the pool tables and dance floor to watch Renny up on stage.

"The odds are incredible," Nelson said, sipping his coffee and watching his old college buddy crooning away.

“Karma,” she said.

“What’s that?”

“Karma,” she said, quieter, wishing she hadn’t.

Nelson frowned, not getting it. Good. Oh, you know, I was having such a good time with you and I don’t deserve you... He asked, “Why karma?”

“I don’t know.” She stuffed ice cream in her mouth so he wouldn’t be tempted to ask her any more questions.



Last song of the night was an up-tempo version of Blake Shelton—that honeybee song or whatever. Boy, Renny should’ve just done Blake Shelton songs all night because the crowd went cuckoo. They were all dancing, shimmying around, course they were all loaded by this point. It was probably a good idea to get home before these hillbillies got on their snowmobiles and started racing around the trails.

Renny brought it in for a big finish, plucking away with some fancy guitar work, standing up off his stool, moving around the stage for once. It got the women up front breathing heavy. He could see a lot of them turning around to make sure their friends were seeing what they were seeing. Yes, he was a good-looking guy with a good physique. He had a good voice... but he was about twenty years younger than you.

Renny quick-strummed, hands moving fast, forearm muscles bulging, tattoos dancing on his skin and the women up front raised fists in the air and whooped. Then he slapped the strings closed, raised his own fist, gave them a bow and slung his guitar over his hip. Women were putting their hands up to touch him, and he reached down to grab at their fingers.

“Oh brother,” Natalie said.

“You don’t want to go up there?”

“That’s the last thing I want,” Natalie said, scooping the last of the brownie in her mouth.

He said, “You got...” and he pointed with two pronged fingers to the corners of his own mouth.

Mouthful of brownie, she said, “I know,” grabbed her napkin and wiped her mouth.

“See, that wasn’t so bad. Look at him up there. One drink, Nat. Then we can go...”

“Whatever,” she said, her voice muffled with brownie.

Renny was done now, backing away and waving at everyone, scanning over the tops of everyone’s heads looking for them, finding them at the table. Nelson gave a hand signal indicating for him to come over. Renny held up the five-minutes signal.

He said to Natalie, “He’ll be over. He’s gotta go backstage first.”

“I can hardly wait,” Natalie said, wiping at her mouth again and looking in her napkin.

Nelson said, “Let’s order something for the road...”



Renny took fifteen fucking minutes backstage, probably fucking that fat girl from the bathroom, or the other one: What Hank won’t know won’t hurt

him. Guy came out refreshed, wearing a scarf still and then a comical towel wrapped around his neck over top of it like he'd just played a hockey game, coming to sit with them and dabbing at his nose.

Renny said, "Holy fuckin' shit, eh?"

Nelson got up, gave his old housemate a hug where he sat. Renny clapped Nelson's back, and he wouldn't look at her. Good. She didn't want to look at him, either.

"How you been, buddy?" Renny said.

"Just great, Renny. We've both been really great. How about you?"

Natalie said, "He's playing gigs in one-horse towns. What do you think?"

Renny laughed, slow-clapped then smirked. "Nice one, Nat. Look at you, it's Christmas time, giving me these presents, and I didn't get you a thing."

"Whatever," she said.

Renny said, "What's up, Nat. You look hot as shit."

She rolled her eyes, folded her arms and leaned back in her chair.

Renny said, "You do. You look good. So what are you guys doing up here?"

Nelson was waving to the bartender, showing up three fingers indicating shots of rye.

Natalie said, "Nelson brought me up here for the weekend. A couples retreat. We got a cabin in the woods."

"How romantic. Ooh la la Nelson. Look at you Mr. Romeo."

Nelson buffed his nails on his shirt and laughed. "I know how to please my woman."

Renny went to say something and closed his mouth then winked at Natalie.

She looked away, folded her arms tighter over her chest.

Renny said, “I just can’t believe how almost a year to the day you guys show up where I’m playing.”

Nelson said, “Natalie says it’s karma.”

“She said that? What does that mean—karma? How’s it karma?”

Natalie waved them both off.

“What’s with her?” Renny asked him.

“She’s tired.”

“Up past her bedtime? Seriously, Nat, I thought you were smart. You don’t know what karma is?”

“I know what karma is and, also, I’m fine,” she said. “I’m totally fine,” and then pretended to brush some dirt off the bib front of her snow pants.

Renny said, “Natalie. I didn’t get my hug.” He leaned back in his chair, opened his arms, knees set wide apart and practically begging for her to take a look. She couldn’t help an automatic glance between Renny’s legs and then darted her face away, scowling and shaking her head, mad at herself.

She watched up on the stage someone from the bar taking down the mic stand and shutting off the equipment. She said, “Whyn’t you get a hug from one of your fans?” She nodded her chin to the dance floor where there were gathered women around the dance floor shooting side glances to their table.

Renny said, “But they’re not good old pals of mine now, are they? I don’t even know them. You know me, don’t you? We know each other pretty good.”

“We do,” Natalie said, punctuating it with an exasperated sigh. Her eyes were turned up, avoiding Nelson and Renny, watching where a rough-hewn cross beam supported the log rafters.

Nelson said, “Seriously, Natalie, what’s going on? You’re being so weird.”

“She is, isn’t she?” Renny said, crossing his arms and sinking into the chair to study Natalie through drowsy eyes.



The bartender was there, instead of bringing shot glasses bringing three tumblers with double shots. He said, “On the house.”

“Isn’t that nice?” Renny said, taking two glasses, Nelson taking the other. Renny handed one to her, when she went to take it, he pulled it back. “Nat, I want my hug first.”

She ran her tongue around the inside of her cheek but slowly got up, came to him bent over with her hips shot way back and gave him a hug. Nelson could see her whisper something in his ear.

This was what it was all about. Nelson could feel himself getting harder, could feel an electric ball of excitement beginning to churn inside him.

“Oh,” Renny said as their embrace came apart and she sat down.

Nelson said, “What’s up? What did she say?”

Renny said, “You want to tell him that or—”

Renny jumped, laughing, drawing his shin back. She’d kicked him. “Ow, hey. Why are you so mean?”

“She is mean, isn’t she?” Nelson said. Now Natalie was showing him a furrowed brow. He said, “What...?”

“Nat,” Renny said. “You have nothing to worry about. Nobody gave me boner pills this year. Everything’s cool...”

Nelson laughed, held up his drink and pointed at Nat. “Hey, you remember that? Remember those girls gave him boner pills?”

Renny said, “She remembers.”

Natalie nodded. She looked at the glass Renny had sat down in front of her, picked it up, set it to her lips then put it back down.

Nelson said, “I don’t know why she’s mad at me. I’m nothing but nice to her.”

“Biting the hand that feeds you,” Renny said and took a sip of his whiskey.

Natalie softened, her shoulders slumped. She said, “I’m not mean to you, Nelson. I’m sorry...”

“That’s better,” Renny said with a smirk.

Now that Nelson saw her soften, he’d turn up the heat. “What’s going on between you two, anyway?”

“What do you mean?” Natalie’s eyes had gone wide, her color sallow.

“Did something happen last year? I was asleep, when I woke up Renny was gone. You two get in a fight?”

Renny chuckled. “Yeah, we got into it. We really got into it.” Natalie’s pale color faded more. “She’s just mad ‘cause she knows I got the better of her.”

Nelson said, “Nat hates to lose.”

“Oh, you did not get the better of me,” Natalie scolded, looking at the floor and shaking her head emphatically.

Renny’s smile widened, and he didn’t answer right away, instead letting the heels of his boots slide along the floor, legs extending, gently tapping

Natalie's shin with the toe of his cowboy boot. "You're right Nat, we both gave it pretty good..."

Natalie's boot scraped the flooring as her leg darted back.

Nelson said, "Well, sounds like I ought to be glad I slept through it."

Renny said, "I can't believe she's still sore after almost a whole year."

"I'm not sore," she murmured, sullen again.

Renny said, "I bet you were the next day."

Nelson had to press his thighs together at the vulgar double entendre. He said, "No, she was good. Didn't even mention it."

"I thought she'd be complaining all day," Renny said, leveling mean eyes at her.

"Didn't say a thing about it," Nelson said, "which is odd, since it seems like it was a big deal."

"It was nothing," she said now, shifting in her seat and raising her chin up to look at both of them. "Believe me, it was nothing."

Nelson said, "But you're still thinking about it."

Renny said, "Yeah, Nat, you're still thinking about it."

She scoffed now, struggled with what to say, settling on: "Why don't you two just leave me alone about it...?"

Nelson chuckled, and he shared a humorous look with Renny before changing the subject. "How does this work out here, Renny? Why you gig all the way up north?"

"It's not far," he said, "not really. Two-hundred a night and I got five shows booked. I'm on vacation from work."

“Wow, a thousand dollars,” Nat said.

“Every bit helps, Natty,” Renny said. “I’m saving for a house.”

“That’s great, man. Moving up in the world.”

“I got a promotion this year—”

“Hey, Nat did too,” Nelson said.

Renny continued: “Good for you, Nat. Yeah, I was promoted, got a raise, I have savings—what am I going to do, go blow my money on some dumb vacation right now? Go get wasted at some resort? I want a place of my own.”

Nelson said, “That’s pretty cool, huh, Nat?”

“I guess,” she said.

Renny said, “It was good seeing you guys last year, you know? Showed me what I wanted. A place like you guys got. Hey, maybe I’ll get a joint in your neighborhood.”

“Just like old times, eh? The three of us in the old stomping grounds.”

Natalie imitated a smile but still scowled at Renny with her eyes.

“Maybe Nat’ll let me in if I make her love me again,” he said and gave Nat a comical sad clown face.

“Hey, do what you want, Renny. World’s your oyster,” she said, shrugging.

“You wouldn’t get the HOA after me for my lawn or something?”

“Take care of your lawn.”

“You don’t think I could?”

“You think you could?”

“I know I could pay someone to do it.”

“Good for you. Yay, you got a promotion.”

“I did. A good one.”

“Cool. That mean you get the manager badge on your Falafel Hut uniform? A special shiny headset?”

“I make more than you do.”

Natalie laughed so hard her head shot back. “Renny, there is no way you make more money than I do.”

“I bet I do.”

“Don’t make me laugh.”

Now Renny scooted his chair, legs squeaking and chirping on the flooring; his knees came to touch Natalie’s and now Nat didn’t look sick anymore, she looked fierce. He said, “We going to compare our cocks?”

“Whip it out.”

“Holy shit, guys,” Nelson laughed. His dick had shot to steel and was twisted in his briefs right now. He showed them his palms like he was a fight promoter trying to calm two heavyweights at the weigh-in. He said, “Save it for the ring.”

Renny put his hands on her. Gripped her snow pants just above her knee and Nat made a steady mean face at him. He said, “You make six-figures?”

“Of course I do. I know you don’t.”

“Why?”

“Come out here to play honky-tonk for a grand a week? Just stay home and invest.”

“All cash, Nat,” Renny said, eyes steady on hers.

“Who cares? What’s tax on a grand? Three-thirty? Stay at home on your couch and trade stock.”

“I do it a couple times a year, and I gig all weekend, every weekend. I know I make more than you do.”

“Renny, you’re not smart enough to make my kind of money.”

Renny leaned closer, said, “Don’t matter, Nat,”—now he squinted and sneered—“I’m a man.”

Natalie slapped his face.

Renny bolted back with glee, rubbing his cheek and laughing.

“You’re such an asshole!”

“Oh, Nat, you’re so easy. I work your little button like a master.”

While Renny laughed and stomped his feet playfully, Nat soothed the palm she’d struck him with, her face in a drawn, exasperated bewilderment. Her cheeks showed rosy blooms.

Nelson said, “Jesus, Nat, what the hell?”

Nat looked only at Renny, saying, “He was asking for it.”

Renny kept his eyes on Nat, saying, “It’s all right, Nelson, I was totally asking for it.”

“Let’s change the subject, for crying out loud,” he said, shifting his chair around, his cock hard as a piston. “So you come out to nowhere, like here, and then what? Where do you stay?”

“Most places have a room to crash in. Then I hit the bus, move on to the next one.”

Natalie scoffed. “The bus? You don’t have a car?”

“I have a truck,” Renny said. “Brand new, V8, 4x4. You know what that costs to drive up here?”

Natalie rolled her eyes.

Nelson said, “Wait? You sleep here? Then you get on a bus?”

“Dude, it’s not glamorous,” Renny said, “but I’d be lying if I said I don’t love it.”

“Sounds sad,” Natalie said. “Sad and lonely.”

“Neither,” Renny said. “Most mornings after, I wake up in the bed of some hottie, her laying satisfied and smiling. She makes me pancakes before I leave.”

“No hotties here,” Natalie said.

“You sure about that?” Renny eyed her up and down.

Nelson jumped in: “Tell you what, dude—no arguments, you’re staying with us tonight.”

Natalie gasped audibly.

Chapter 6

Best scenario right now was her nailing this snow machine into a tree; Renny on the back without a helmet, he'd rag doll off the trunk of a maple and she wouldn't have to explain to her husband why there was no way in hell this asshole should be coming back with them. And yet he fucking was.

Arguing at this point was making matters worse; it was showing Nelson she had something to hide. Here they were thrust into this awful situation that spiked her anxiety so high she had to sit down at one point and it was all because proximity to Renny could bring out the truth of what she'd done last year; so what does she do?—the worst thing imaginable; act like such a psycho bitch it was obvious to Nelson his wife had something to hide.

So Nelson says Hey, Renny, you're coming back to stay with us, no arguments. And she nods, slow, but not letting Renny see her sweat.

But she had almost literally swallowed her tongue.

Out at the snow machines it gets worse: Nelson says for Renny to ride with her. She balks of course, says why would he ride with her...? Nelson said his back was sore and didn't want someone to be clutched to him. Renny said to her, "Give me the keys, Nat, I'll drive." She said, "You drive? You don't have a helmet or a decent winter coat. Seriously, how is it a year later and you're making the big bucks apparently and you're still bumbling around in the winter with a dumb leather jacket? You better get behind me so I can block the wind." Then this jerk-off looks her up and down and she knows he's thinking of some way to say she's put on weight, but he bites his tongue, which was good because she would have sincerely kicked him in the balls with one of her snow boots.

So now they were on the trail taking the longest ten-minute trail ride ever back to the cabin; she's got this asshole waiting for the right moment to honk her titties or grab her cooch, making her arms tense like steel cables

and her fingers go hard on the throttle. Renny was pressed right to her, his arms squeezing her middle, his hips humped right up into her butt and she had the machine pegged at 70k.

They'd lost Nelson behind them on the last curve.

Renny's arms cinched her tighter, and she was sure she could feel his grip squeezing her bosom over her parka...



When Nelson crested the last hill, and the cabin lit up in his snowmobile's headlight, Renny and Nat were off their snow machine and he could have sworn his wife had just thumped Renny's arm. And Renny was laughing, taking it in good spirits, rubbing his arm but now huddling up like he was cold. Natalie had turned her back to him, helmet still on and shining in the cone of light from the single yellowy bulb under the cabin's covered porch.

Nelson pulled up alongside Natalie's snowmobile and now his wife and his former house mate were lit up bright white by his light's beam, Natalie impatient standing at the door with her hands on her hips because he had the key, and Renny sidled up beside her, shivering, his hands clutching the lapels of his jacket around his chin. Machine shut down, he got off and joined them, fishing the cabin's key out of his pocket.

Renny was saying, "Hurry u-up, du-ude," and Natalie just glared at him from behind her visor—he could feel the heat from her stare from beneath the helmet.

"Got it, got it," he said, holding up the key to show them before sliding it into the lock, getting the door open. He shoved it, then stood gesturing in for them to proceed. Renny was the first one in, scrambling, heaving a sound of relief at the feel of the cabin's heat.

Nelson said, “You should have felt it earlier, I had it so hot in here Natalie was melting.”

Renny snatched up a blanket off their couch and wrapped himself in it, standing hunched, teeth chattering. He said, “Du-ude, Nelson, I-I will give you a-anything to m-make it that hot ag-again...”

“Let me get on it,” Nelson said, “half an hour you’ll be down to your skivvies.”

“That’s what I’m hoping,” Renny said.

Natalie popped the helmet off, then shook her head like she was trying to loose her hair—forgetting he’d helped braid it into two fat tails because she said it was too greasy to wear down going to a restaurant. He caught her now putting her helmet on the high shelf above the coat hooks, absently smoothing a hand over the tails.

Renny said, “Wow, look at your wolf den,” scanning around the space they’d been living in these last thirty-six hours. Air mattress on the floor, scattered sheets, blankets thrown over the couch, dirty plates, empty glasses and bottles... “You guys are going all out.” He kicked an empty can of IPA with the toe of his boot and it made a hollow, aluminum sound, rolling a half circle before resting in a pile of clothes.

“We’ve been having a good time,” Nelson said.

“I’ll say,” Renny laughed, bending down with his blanket shroud hanging over him like he was James Brown, snatching something off the floor. When he stood upright again, the blanket fell and he held up a pair of Natalie’s panties held between his two hands, showing them off. “Sexy Natalie,” he said. “You not wearing panties tonight, honey, you bad girl...”

“Those are old,” Natalie said, stomping the distance between them, looking to swipe them away from Renny.

When she tried, Renny twisted to keep them out of her grasp. He turned them around now, looking at the back of them. “Thong, Nat? God, I would

kill to see you in them.”

“I will honestly kill you if you don’t hand them over,” she said, palm held out.

“Why you so uptight, Natty? Uh-oh, I check in the seat I’m going to see a bacon strip?” He opened the panties, pretended to peer into them but kept his eyes on her instead.

“You’re so disgusting,” she said and snatched them, shoved them in the pocket of her coat.

Renny just laughed her off, threw himself into their couch and sat with his legs stretched out. The bulge in the crotch of his jeans was obvious—no underwear, balls probably in his body from the cold ride, there was still an outline of his huge flaccid member. Natalie saw it, he was sure, and she clucked her tongue and exhaled in exasperation, returned to the front door to take off her stuff.

Nelson removed his own jacket, saying, “So this is the main room, where we crash obviously. In the back room, there’s the wood stove—in the spring that’s where we cooked the sap and everything—there’s a mini-kitchen there, but no electricity or running water so we’re on a genny. No toilet, but there’s an outhouse across from where we parked the machines.”

Renny said, “Wow, the lap of luxury, I see why you wanted me to come out here, save me from the awful back room at the bar.”

Nelson laughed it off, said, “Hey, man, you got our company, there’s a ton of beers out the back door in the other room; we got whisky, a soon-to-be hot ass fire. We’re going to have a good time and you know it.”

“Just playing, Nelson. I know what you’re offering. I know and appreciate it.” Now his head lolled and he said loudly in Natalie’s direction, “I hope your wife heard me say that.”

“I heard it,” she said, hanging up her jacket. “And I agree, you would have been better off at the bar. Want me to run you back?”

“I said I like it here,” Renny said. “Now come sit next to your buddy and let’s patch us up. We used to be such good friends.”

“We were never friends, Renny,” she corrected him.

“We were friends last year. Remember how good we were together?”

Natalie shook her head at him, mouth tweaked to one side, eyes narrow and studying. Arms crossed she leaned against the wall between the hanging coats and the window looking out the side toward the snowy trail; orangey flakes of snow fluttered in the black, lit up by the porch light. “You going to be decent to me?”

“I swear,” he said, putting up his hands, “I won’t try to peek into your underwear anymore.”

Natalie shook her head more, made a chuckle laced with a growl.

Nelson said, “I’ll stoke that fire, get it hot in here.”

Renny said, “Good, I’m waiting to see Nat out of her snow pants, want to see how the body’s holding up.”

“I look fucking great, buddy,” she said.

“Let’s see it,” Renny said, but Nat still stared at him, arms crossed, not ready to take off her snow pants yet.

“Who wants beers?” Nelson asked, pausing at the door to the cook room, watching back as Nat stared Renny down. Both of them said, “Me.” Then Nat amended, “I’ll have a Coke.”

“Cool,” he said, left them alone, went into the cook room and levered the flue wide, took a poker and jabbed at the coals, cleared away ash and got the bed a frightening fiery orange. That was his lust right now: a hot field of fiery coals begging for kindling, begging for fuel. He snuck a peek into the main room, saw his wife puttering around, clearing some of their mess while Renny watched her work, sitting on the couch and smirking.

There was wood stacked under the window to the cook room and they had enough supply to last overnight, but he stacked a few logs into the hungry stove, grabbed two cans of beer and a Coke out the back door, brought them into the main room.

“So thirsty, buddy,” Renny said, catching a tossed can in both hands, quickly popping the top.

Nelson handed the Coke can to Natalie, saying, “I’m going out for a few minutes, going to grab some firewood for overnight.”

“Take this guy with you,” she said, popping her own top and slurping the suds expanding out the tab hole.

“Guy doesn’t have a jacket,” he said, “plus I just pass it through the kitchen window, only gonna be a few minutes and, truth be told, I gotta visit the latrine.”

“Some truths are best hidden,” Renny said.

Natalie shot Renny an uncomfortable look and Nelson couldn’t believe how well this was going.



Nelson went through the cook kitchen, checked on the fire again; she heard the stove door lever scissor, then the back door open and close. She could see the motion detector light flash on and her husband’s shadow scrawl across the snow.

Renny was sitting on the couch, legs stretched out, one crossed over the other and just fucking smirking. She said, “Would you cool it, please?”

“Cool what?”

“All the dirty double entendre, okay, I don’t think it’s funny.”

“I do. Nelson does.”

“Don’t fuck around, please. Don’t hurt Nelson. If you care about him, don’t fuck around like that, saying those things.”

“Speaking of cool...”

“What does that mean?”

“It means don’t worry, Nelson’s cool.”

“I don’t even know why you agreed to come out here. You must really hate me.”

“I don’t hate you at all, Nat. But I did come out here to stick it to you.”

She grumbled, leaning against the wall again and watching Nelson’s shadow work out there. “You’re sticking it to me, all right.” Dry firewood made its hollow clattering sound from the cook room as Nelson stacked their supply through the open kitchen window.

“Not yet, I’m not.”

“Oh really?” she laughed, “This isn’t sticking it to me?”

“Not the way I mean.” He gave her a sly smile and let his eyes travel up her body.

“There’s not a chance, buddy.”

“You don’t think that’s why I’m here?”

“You hope my husband falls asleep again?”

“Or pretends to.”

“Whatever.”

“Come on now, Nat, he wants us to. Why do you think I’m here? A big coincidence, you guys coming out to a place where I’m playing. I mean, what are the chances? It’s astronomical.”

“It’s not that crazy, we’re all white, we’re all the same age, we all went to the same school, our life experiences are the same, it means we travel in the same vectors, it might seem astronomical to you but you weren’t very good at statistics.”

“Oh please, naïve Natalie, I’m telling you he knew.”

“There’s no way. No way. Do you ever listen to yourself? Ever hear how stupid you sound? You would be astounded.”

“I’m not stupid, Natalie. I put it on thick that night. I put it on thick because I knew your buddy Nelson wanted me to.” Now he rose from the couch and stretched, put his empty can on the table. Hands in his pockets he watched her, aloof and drowsy eyes looking at her like she was the only person in the room who didn’t know the game and how sad it was she couldn’t keep up. She wanted to slap him again, slap that smug expression off his face. Hip-cocked and arrogant; she took him in, confident, cool Renny, so cooler than all of them back at the house on Baker Street with his badass hair and his sleeve tattoos and his ‘fuck-this-shit, let’s party’ attitude that had girls coming in and out of the old house back in the day. Her eyes found their way between his legs and she snapped away, but registered the size of the thing pressing out the inseam of his tight jeans.

She sighed; her wonderful, dutiful husband’s shadow out there stretching over the piles of snow as he performed the chores that would keep them happy and warm and safe. She fucking loved that guy so much. She said, “Nelson didn’t want it, and you’re crazy if you think he wants it tonight.”

“I’m not crazy,” he said, coming to join her.

She said, “You think he brought us here together so we can have sex? First of all, I will never have sex with you again, ever. That’s a fact. And if

there's any truth in you saying he knows what we did, he didn't arrange to bring us here to get us to do it again, it's because he's going to murder us. He's out for firewood but I bet it's so he can get the axe..."

Renny chuckled, came to stand behind her, both of them peering out the window at a steep angle but only able to see Nelson's shadow. He said, "I'm not worried one bit."

"You should be. If not him, me, if you keep up that dirty talk."

"I'm telling you, Nat, he brought me here so he could watch me fuck you again. Your husband thought about it all year long and he set this night up."

"Bull shit."

"You know what, Nat? Why do you think I got on the back of that snowmobile? Come out here and you can insult me all night? I could be back at the bar, five free whiskeys down and hot in my belly, getting a blow job from a waitress before I tuck in for the night. Why did I freeze my balls off coming out here?"

She scoffed at the gross imagery. "Why?"

"I thought about it all year, just like Nelson. Top five hottest fuck sessions I ever had, you're in that."

"Oh wow, how cool, you comp me some merch?"

He touched her hair and she darted a shoulder up to protect her ear. Her scalp crawled and her nipples went to marbles.

Renny said, "If Nelson wants me to fuck you, I'll—"

The door banged closed in the cook room and Nelson stomped his boots and made exclamatory sounds of cold. She moved away from Renny's range of touch and warned him, "Don't touch me, don't make dirty jokes tonight, and don't tease me—we'll get along just fine."

Now he lounged against the wall by the window, smiling. “You be good to me, Nat, I’ll be good to you.”

“That’s all I want.”

He brought his hand out of his front pocket and held it out, his pinky finger extended and crooked.

She posed her hand the same as his and they hooked their pinkies together, locked eyes.

Nelson came in the main room now, slinging off his coat, breath still frosty as he gave them a pleased smile, said, “Aw, you guys call a truce?”

Chapter 7

He'd come in to see his wife locking pinkies with Renny—a somehow erotic sight. Nat's chestnut hair in its thick curving braids, her sweet face; wearing her flannel shirt and her bib snow pants. The sight and its implication somehow thrilling; flooding his sex system with nitrous.

He kept it cool, saying, "Fire's stoked,"—and he meant it—"won't be long now till you'll be complaining it's too hot."

"Doubt it," Renny said, sloughing off his leather jacket and scarf, hanging them on a hook as Natalie came to the center of the room, standing near their air mattresses. She stooped, picked up the wool blanket he'd been shrouded in moments ago and tossed it to him.

Renny caught it with one hand and wore it like a shawl again. Natalie said, "I think your friend needs another beer."

"Renny," Nelson said, "you finish that beer already?—I was out for like two minutes."

"You told me you brought me out here to show me a good time."

Nat gave Renny another scolding look, and it seemed like the truce was already on shaky grounds. He wondered what it was his wife and the guy she'd cheated on him with talked about while he was outside.

Nelson kept things moving (though he'd prefer a shaky truce): "How 'bout you, Nat?"

She shook her head no, watching Renny over her shoulder and biting the inside of her lower lip. "I don't need anything," she said.

Renny waved her off, saying, "Yeah, Nat's easy to please," and returning to his spot on the couch.

Natalie's brow lowered now, but she shook it off, made her face pleasant again, coming to stand before her husband. "What do you want to do now?"

"I want to get this place hot," he told her, "then whatever. We'll see what happens. Hey, Ren?—what do you want to do?"

"Let's play it by ear, we'll see what comes up"—grinning at Nat—"but shoot, I should have brought my guitar."

"Yes," Nat said, "then the evening would have been complete—what a shame you left it at the bar."

"Damn it," Renny said, "I left my bag there, too. I don't have any clothes to change into."

Nelson said, "I'll set you up, don't worry," and double-rapped on the door frame, passing through the cook room to replenish Renny's beer.

When he came back, he found them both sitting on the couch, Renny at one end, Nat at the other, looking surly and closed off with her arms folded and her legs crossed. He tossed Renny a fresh beer and came to sit between them, clasping his wife's thigh and giving it a squeeze. "Nat, what's with the snow pants?"

Renny said, "She's keeping them on so I won't see what's happened to her."

She shot forward to talk around Nelson, saying, "Oh really? And what's happened to me?"

"Take those puffy pants off and I'll let you know."

"Yeah? I can't wait to hear what you think of my body." Massive eye roll.

"I tell you, last year at Christmas, you in that long shirt? You looked fucking hot even if you put on a few."

"I didn't even put on a few..."

“Well, whatever, your stuff is falling into place then, I don’t know, it’s a compliment, I said it already. Like maybe you were too thin in college.”

She huffed, shook her head, looking like she wanted to scratch his face. “I was never too thin.”

Renny said, “Take off your pants, Nat.”

Now she eyeballed Nelson, and it made him flinch. She said, “Yeah, good, why don’t you sit there and let him talk to me like this with that smirk on your face, some great guy you’re supposed to be.”

Nelson couldn’t help a funny laugh, and Renny was right on top of her: “Yeah, Nelson, fight your wife’s battles for you like a good husband should. A woman can’t fend on her own...”

Natalie looked up to the ceiling and laughed; her foot was kicking and bobbing. She said, “Shit, you’re good. You fight dirty...”

“I fuck dirty, too, Nat.”

“Good for you,” she said.

Nelson looked left and right at the both of them, saying, “I don’t know how I got in the middle of this.”

“I tell you what, Nelson,” Renny said, “I can see your body, and you never looked better. Eh, Nat? Your hubby is looking fit.”

It softened her; she leaned against Nelson’s arm, her hands clutched his bicep. “He goes to the gym four days a week. I can’t keep my hands off him.”

“Good work, Nelson. You go too, Nat?”

She groaned, sat upright, looked to the ceiling and made a quiet growling sound, scratching at her neck. “No, I don’t go to the gym.”

“Oh, no biggie. Anyway, seriously, Nelson, you never looked better.”

“Thanks, man.”

It was quiet and uncomfortable for a long, long moment and Nelson loved it; couldn't wipe the smile off his face.

Renny said, “Seriously, Nat, can you take those snow pants off? It's driving me crazy; it feels like you're getting ready to leave or something. I can't relax with you in those loud ass pants swishing when you breathe, and you got your boots on still...”

Nat stood up with a whisking puffy-fabric sound that made him have to stifle a laugh. She said, “I think I'm just going to go to bed. How 'bout that?”



Renny said, “Aw, Nat, don't be the party pooper. You were never that girl.”

“What girl?”

“You know, the drama queen gotta blow up everything, make it all about her.”

“You're right, Renny, I'm not that girl. It's not about me, that's why I'm going to bed. It's not like I'm storming off down a dark alley so the boys will have to follow me, I'm going to be right here.”

Nelson said to her: “Nat, come on...” He put a hand out inviting her to return to the couch and she looked in his eyes. The thought he might have arranged this encounter was crazy with a capital C. And disgusting with a capital D. What she'd done would never be repeated and Renny's dumb idea that Nelson wanted this was the stupidest thing somebody could say about a woman's husband. The kind of thing that shithead would say to a

woman, trying to get in her pants again. And yet there was something warm and weird in Nelson's eyes; a wanting, a longing. Fuck you, Nat. It was Renny getting in her head; doing it on purpose. Like he said: sticking it to her.

She said, "You stay up. Have fun with your friend. I'm exhausted because you made me go hiking. It's like," she looked at the old sunburst clock up on the pine-paneled wall—"almost two o'clock in the morning." Nelson gave her no expression, hand still held out, that watery, yearning sort of face. What?—he wanted her to come and sit between him and the guy she cheated with? There was no way Nelson knew. No way at all; if he did, he would be devastated. She'd ruined him and he didn't know it. If he found out she'd fucked Renny, he would crumble. Her poor, sweet, innocent man. But he couldn't hate her more than she hated herself.

"Let her go," Renny said, "maybe she'll finally take those snow pants off."

"You're so juvenile," she said.

Truth was she didn't want to take them off because he would look. Maybe she didn't look as hot as she did in college, maybe she'd got a little soft. She didn't think she did; there were a lot of guys at the office straight-up eye-fucking her, ones that didn't were checking her out when they thought she wasn't looking. But what if her thighs jiggled a little when she took the pants off? Renny would point it out and she didn't want to have to deal with that right now. Or ever.

There was a low, upholstered arm chair by the front door and she plopped herself into it, began unlacing her boots. It was getting hot in here. A strand of her hair had come loose from the braid and it hung down while she got the boots off, and she saw the curl it was taking from the damp heat. Nelson must have put a pot of water on the stove; she'd complained of dryness this morning.

She kicked the boots off, worked the suspenders of her snow pants over her shoulders; avoiding the boys' gaze but seeing their faces in her periphery turned to watch her. She wanted to say something snarky, maybe tell them to drink their beers but it would be a sign of weakness; a way to let Renny

know he was getting to her. Fuck that guy, though, she wore yoga pants underneath... so she stood and shimmied the snow pants down her legs and stepped out of them.

Now she walked to the air mattress in her flannel shirt and her leggings and socks. Renny popped his beer, and Nelson watched her. It was getting warm in here. At the doorway to the cook room she peered in to see the seams in the rickety old stove glowing a sizzling orange, the light seepage enough to illuminate the whole area in a dim, fiery color. A pot of water billowed steam on the top of the stove.

“How’s my fire?” Nelson asked her.

She said, “You’re going to burn the place down.”

“It’s getting nicer in here now,” Renny said, letting his legs stretch out again.

“Nicer?” she said, “there’s a wet wall of heat here.” She waved her arm in the doorway, feeling the damp on her bare hand.

“Cozy,” Nelson said.

“You’re going to be too hot sleeping in that, Nat,” Renny said, then sipping his beer and peering at her smugly over the curve of the can.

“You’re not going to leave me alone, huh?”

“You love it,” he said.

She looked at Nelson again and she swore he was enjoying the show.

“Whatever,” she said, “enjoy your fantasy.”

“Remember back in college?—didn’t she ride her bike everywhere? That silver cruiser with the basket on it...”

“Yeah, she did,” Nelson said.

“I get plenty of exercise, Renny.”

“Once a year, ‘round Christmas time?”

She scowled, but it made him beam.

Nelson said, “I don’t get it,” looking from Renny to her.

She said, “The hike today,” glaring at Renny.

“She did good out there,” Nelson said, “and she—”

“You don’t need to say it, Nelson.”

“I don’t doubt it,” Renny said. “When she’s eager, I bet she works up a real sweat.”

“You’re so fucking smug,” she said, shaking her head at him and showing no fear, unbuttoning her flannel. She wore a snug sleeveless T-shirt underneath.

Renny said, “But a woman’s only got so many good years...”

Even Nelson reacted to that one, making an Oh shit! face then trying to wipe it away, looking nervous; knowing his wife could blow up. But she played it cool, saying, “You’re going to fuck twenty-year-old groupies when you’re forty, sitting on that stool with your sagging man-tits and turkey neck? I’m sure they won’t have moved on to more talented, younger musicians, ones who never flopped, still have a chance to make something out of their talent...”

Nelson said, “Jesus, Nat...”

“It’s alright, Nelson, I’m going to look like Brad Pitt when I’m forty, and Natty knows it.”

Natalie ran her hands under the waistband of her yoga pants, freeing them from her creases, saying, “Brad Pitt’s deadbeat brother, maybe, if he has one, comes around the house once a year with his hand out looking for money.”

Renny was unfazed. “But he looks fuckin’ good doing it. Bet if I come around and ask Nelson, he’s got something to offer. Eh, Nelson? You wouldn’t let me go dry...”

“What are you asking for?” Nelson said, trying to play along with the joke and not getting it.

“You know, man—your handsome buddy shows up on your doorstep once a year with a desperate longing, you wouldn’t deprive him of what he needs...”

Nelson said, “I’d make you play your guitar or something,” joking, not seeing the implication, “play at my birthday party for money or something. Nothing’s for free.”

Her poor husband. The butt of the joke. Renny trashing his friend, taunting him how he fucked his wife, and Nelson oblivious. Doing it right in his face.

“Hey, Renny,” she said, ready to show him her legs, as smooth as they may have got.

Renny wasn’t done with Nelson, saying now, “But I think it’s really Natalie who’s got needs...”

The vision of him sitting on the couch like that, arms crossed, Mr. Cool and Superior, warbled with rage; last visit to her doctor, she’d said her blood pressure was a little high for a woman her age. She said, “Fuck you, Renny,” and pushed down the leggings, scrolling them inside out along her thighs, kicking her feet out one at a time, stomping on the legs, standing now in her panties and socks with her hands on her hips. “What did you want to say?”

Both Nelson and Renny stared straight at her, eyes darting up her legs and over her body. Nelson’s cute smile started to stretch out his cheeks, and it got her smiling too. Renny gave her a good look, laughed.

Head bobbing, she said, “Did you have something to say?”

Renny said, “Look how hairy your snatch is, Nat, you’re just letting it all go...” He regaled with laughter, putting his hands up to preemptively protect himself—practically begging for her to slap him—and now she was stomping, coming around the coffee table. Her shirt flapped open, her T-shirt was snug, and when she’d pulled down the leggings, they’d rolled her panties with them, pulling the sides down her hips and flipping the front triangle over in half; the top of her bush popped over for both guys to see—and the sound of Renny making fun of her had her cheeks blazing, ears ringing; now her vision was warbled with tears.

“Just shut the fuck up, you asshole,” she cursed him, neck tight, voice constricted trying not to cry.

He put a knee up to block her and it made her want to hit him harder; she loomed over him while he was saying, “Easy, Nat, easy, I’m joking...”

She had a fist cocked over her shoulder, a hard shaking fist that wanted to land right on his pouting lips. But she grabbed at him instead, rage boiling over; she had a vision of her hand grabbing his chest and squeezing so hard his skin stretched and tore and he poured blood between her fingers.

“You’re such a fucking, fucking asshole!”

Now she was grabbing him, taking a handful of his shirt right over his heart and ripping at him, dragging her nails on him; wanting to hurt him—but Renny grabbed her wrist and pulled her hand free; he laughed at her like she was stupid and she punched him with the other hand, thumping his chest with the heel like a hammer. He laughed harder, and now she made a claw and aimed to rake his face. He grabbed that wrist too, and she fell on to him, her bare legs straddling him, seething, teeth bared.

“Natty,” he said, “Natty, calm down, I’m joking...”

Through clenched teeth she hissed: “Stop joking—just shut up already.”

“Natalie, stop,” he said, resisting her struggling arms, looking in her eyes. “Stop, Nat, I’m fucking with you. Why do you care so much about what I think?”

“That’s the last thing I care about.” She scowled; nostrils flared, eyes bulging.

“Right, so easy, baby, I’m teasing you, okay?”

Still she glowered.

“Okay? Okay, Nat? Truth is I like it. I like it a lot. I’m just trying to get to you. You’re fun okay? I’m going to let your hands go...”

Breath heaved in and out, her heart pounded a whooshing sound in her ear drums. Renny’s grip on her wrists loosened, and she kept her hands in claws but didn’t scratch him. His eyes were on hers and she still showed him through her eyes what she wanted to do to him.

“I like it a lot, Nat,” he soothed. “I do.” Now he rested his warm hands on her bare thighs, smoothed them up and down and her scalp tingled like she’d been zinged at an outlet. “I think it’s super-sexy, Natty,” he said now, the strokes of his hands getting more protracted, coming higher up her thigh.

Her pulse still pounded, breath scored her nostrils like snorts.

“But, Nat, I think we should cover it up,” he said so soft it tickled her ears and made her skin prickle. “What do you say?” Both his middle fingers tucked into her panties waistband and ran back and forth. His skin touched her sensitive soft stomach. He curled those fingers, unfurled the fabric, tugged it upward, straightening. His fingers tickled through her pubic hair and now her nipples shot to buds; going so quick it stole her breath.

“There, Nat,” he said, looking in her eyes. “No need to be embarrassed, I like what you’ve got.” Now his fingers curled inside the leg hole trim and he straightened it over her mound; hands between her warm thighs, the backs of his fingers slipped over her labia and her consciousness flitted. Lips sucked in her mouth, she bit down, eyes flickering over Renny, going wide-screen now to take in her husband. Nelson had slumped in the couch toward Renny; his eyes were wide and electric, his chest puffed out as if he’d held his breath. She watched as his eyes moved from where Renny’s

hands touched her between her legs up her body to find her eyes. Instead of hurt she saw excitement.

Now Renny admired how her panties cupped her sex, cocking his head left then right. He put his palm over her mound, fingers right between her legs, stroking her labia over the cotton. "Sorry, Nat, if you took that the wrong way. You're all natural and that's hot as fuck." Now he smiled, withdrew his hand, folded his arms but kept his eyes locked on hers.

The room was dead quiet. Unless the two of them heard her heart as clearly as she did. Nelson sucked on his lower lip, eyes still bugging; Renny sneered and watched her ease out of his lap, quietly stand and straighten her clothes. She took a step back, still watching them. Nelson did nothing, gawped at her. After what another man just did, her husband made no move to stop him or kick him out. He watched it happen. Ghosts of Renny's fingers still touched between her legs, and she could feel the coolness there as she moved and stirring air passed over her damp, sexual heat. Both boys watched her walk backward, and no one said a thing. Nelson gulped dryly, his Adam's apple bobbing twice. She made it all the way to the air mattress walking backward. Now she lowered herself, put a hand out behind her and sat cross-legged on the bed, still watching them. They watched her back. She lay on her side, head on the pillow, still facing them, pulled the zipped-open sleeping bag to cover her like a blanket, tucked a finger in the back of her socks, peeled them off and pushed them from out from under the covers where they fell off the low edge of the mattress.

Chapter 8

The jig was up, and he was so sure of it his upper lip sweated a liquid mustache. No matter how many times he cleared it, it kept returning. It also felt near a hundred degrees in here...

That look on Natalie's face when Renny touched her underneath her panties—touched her pubic hair, who knows, maybe even her labia!—was intense. If Natalie was innocent, she should have slapped him harder than ever, pulled his shirt over his head like a hockey jersey and kicked his ass out of the cabin and into the cold. Only she didn't—she let him adjust her panties then looked to her husband who also should have punched the guy right in the mouth. He didn't do anything either. Renny touched her pussy, and they both went quiet. They looked in each other's eyes. What he learned: Natalie didn't hate Renny's touch; she may hate the man, but not his touch. What she learned: Her husband didn't go crazy seeing her touched intimately by another man. What did she learn looking in his eyes? That was the scary part.

But now Nat lay in bed, turned on her side with her head on a pillow, watching both of them. It made him unsure. There was a look on her face of bewilderment. Almost fear; and that he got off on. However, the way her eyes watched them, blinking every ten seconds, gaze unwavering, made him feel like if he got up and motioned to Renny, they could climb into bed with her and with some reassuring talk have a threesome. There was an expectation in her eyes. Like she'd figured something out, and now she was waiting for her husband to prove her right. Only he didn't want that. So instead, he shifted to sit sideways and talked to Renny. The bulge in his friend's pant leg had thickened—he could tell with a few quick glances, that hot exchange with Natalie definitely getting his friend's pilot light lit—but soon they were talking about hockey and drinking their beer. See, Nat?—nothing going on here...

That fear he saw in her eyes had prompted its own erotic joy, and he wanted to enjoy it a little longer. Natalie was considering whether Nelson knew she'd cheated or not. The idea that she was tortured by her transgression was deeply exciting; that she loved him so much she was struck with terror at the idea he would know what an awful person he'd married. While Renny talked, a dirty, swirling ball whirled in his belly—that feeling when the roller coaster drops—and it was running its tickling tendrils outward, slithering up inside the length of his hard cock.

Natalie alternately tried to sleep, lay and watched them without saying anything, bit at her lower lip. After twenty minutes she turned over and showed them her back. The whole time he'd carried an inane conversation with Renny his stomach had tightened in anticipation until it cramped.

Now Renny was tugging at his light wool sweater to vent, saying, “Shit, Nelson, it's so fucking hot in here now.”

“I know, I know,” he said, “I'll turn it down. I think I'm hitting the sack now, anyway.”

“Yeah, me too,” Renny said, “I'm beat. Plus that heat's got me woozy.”

Nelson got up, put his can on the table and stretched. He saw Renny's arousal had faded, though the guy had no trouble filling out the front of his pants when flaccid. Renny put his can next to Nelson's, sat back and peeled off his sweater, his thick rake of hair splitting and a long strand falling over his handsome face. Renny was looking fit, too; thin, but with lean muscle; tattoo sleeves up both arms, leather bracelets, a long silver chain around his neck. Renny caught him looking; their eyes met but neither said a thing, nor gave anything away.

Renny said, “That fire, dude.”

“I'm on it.”

He went in the cook room, found the fire still roaring enough the black stove pipe sounded like a freight train roared within; the iron pot of water

he'd rested on top had sizzled itself bone dry. He wrenched the flue lever closed and the chimney's rumble faded; a log popped.

When he returned, Renny was silent, standing by the table lamp, poised to turn it off. He'd removed his cowboy boots, now just wore skinny jeans and a V-neck T-shirt. Again, nothing was said, though they locked eyes for a long moment.

Renny said, "Night, Nelson."

"Night, Renny..."

Renny switched off the light.



The whole time she lay there blinking and watching her husband sit and talk with Renny, she was sure any second they were both going to make some move; some dude head nod, then come to the bed together and try to both have sex with her. Sleeping bag pulled up to her chin, she peeped out at them, heart racing, but they made no move. After a while she began to calm. Nelson talked to Renny about hockey, about work, asking about touring...

Then what the fuck was that on the couch? Why would Nelson let his friend do that to her? Why would Nelson let another man slip a finger under her panties and graze her pussy? He had to know he did; there was nothing blocking his view. Renny didn't hide it. And that look on Nelson's face...? The shock, the bewilderment... She'd at first thought he'd been excited by it—Renny put that shit in her head—but now with the hockey talk it occurred to her; was he wide-eyed because she'd let Renny do it and didn't slap his face? Here she was looking at her husband wondering if Renny was right that he wanted this and she was flabbergasted, but all along she didn't even

realize: Nat, baby, you let a man touch your pussy right in front of your husband and didn't lose your shit. Wow, way to go, Nat. Why don't you make it more obvious there's something going on between you and Renny? Fuck.

If it came out, she'd pondered lying. Telling Nelson she had sex with Renny but it was back in college and that's why she doesn't like him around. But the thought of being so deceitful to Nelson made her sick to her stomach. She would never lie. No, she would never lie but she was a master craftsman at omission. She would have to tell him. Not here, and not with Renny present. But she couldn't live like this. She'd prefer a weekend like this being spent waiting to tell him good news, but she supposed, the right thing to do would be to tell the man she loved the truth.

Then she rolled over. Then the room became an oven. She had to fold over the sleeping bag. She slept in panties, T-shirt, bra, flannel shirt; now she was baking. But she wouldn't disrobe in front of Renny.

Nelson was up and moving around in the cook room, and she put her hands under her shirt and unhooked her bra—oh, fuck, what a relief. Renny moved around behind her, off the couch, maybe taking his boots off. She rolled to that side but made sure not to look at him, kept her eyes narrow; saw him move near the front door like he would turn off the light.

In the cook room, she heard the flue scissor closed, and Nelson return. Through her fluttering lashes she peeked to see Renny looking at Nelson—then the light was switched off and the room went black. Only the yellowing porch-light was still on, so while the room was dark, the window outside was lit up in bright gunmetal and fast moving fat flakes of snow moved left to right. Renny moved into view, his silhouette a clear black shape against the snowy night sky; Nelson moved past him, they muttered good nights, see you in the mornings; Nelson shuffled around the foot of the mattress and came behind her. She heard the static sounds of his clothing being whisked off.

Nelson said, “Oh shoot, man, you don't have anything to sleep in. You want a pair of my sweatpants?”

“No, I’m cool.”

“Hey, no, I insist, what are you going to do, sleep in your jeans.”

“I’m good,” Renny said, “if it’s alright, I’m going to sleep buck.”

There was a pause, then Nelson said, “That’s cool with me. Cover up—Nat wakes up in the middle of the night and sees your schlong out, she’ll flip.”

“I’m sure she would,” Renny said and his hands came together at his waist; the dragging metal sound of his fly was huge in the quiet. Nelson was behind her, scratching his leg or his armpit or something, yawning, then settling in, bouncing her up and down on the air mattress.

Renny’s fly opened, and she saw the movement of something large there, then he was pushing the tight jeans down his legs, standing sideways to the window. She had a clear outlined image of his huge penis swinging and bouncing. Then he kicked his feet out of them; that dong wiggling and slapping. While he stretched his T-shirt over his head, he arched his back and it thrust his penis out. The thing was unreal; circus worthy, for sure. Totally soft, the thing was longer and thicker than Nelson’s strongest erection; it hung almost halfway down his thighs; the head looked like a big army helmet with its thick pronounced lip. A year ago she had got quite familiar with it; specifically because she knew it was huge; saw it through his pants, had heard stories. She’d given him a hand job. And didn’t stop there...

Nelson shifted close behind her, his hand coming to caress her waist. He said, “Hey, you awake?”

She nodded, still watching Renny’s naked silhouette and remembering the bad she’d done.

“Why you wearing your flannel? You’re going to roast...”

“Uh-huh,” she said.

Then Nelson's mouth was very near her ear, whispering, "Are you looking at his dick?"

"No," she hissed. Worked her mouth around a bit, then rolled her eyes.
"Yes," she said in a soft whisper.

"You're bad," he said, and his hand slapped at her butt cheek once and gave her a squeeze.

"No, I'm not," she lied.

Then her husband's sweet lips kissed the ridge of her ear, and he said,
"Night, Nat, I love you, see you in the morning."

She rolled over, cuddled herself to him, kissed his neck. "I love you, buddy. I love you so much." Nelson put his arm under her ear and she rested her head in the crook of his collar.

The bed jostled; she was bounced up and down as Renny lowered himself on their air mattress and lay in the spot behind her, not wearing a thing. Every cord and cable inside her stretched to the point of snapping...



Natalie tensed against him; her body stiffening as she became aware that Renny was coming into the bed with them. And Renny acted cool, didn't overplay his hand. Natalie clung herself to her husband tighter, nuzzled her cheek into his shoulder. She was burning up; hot as an oven. The sleeping bag was turned down, but she still wore her flannel shirt.

Nelson held her like that for maybe ten minutes. Renny did nothing, and Nelson stared at the ceiling listening to everyone breathe. Soon, Natalie stilled. Nervous at first about why Renny would be climbing into bed with

them, but then enjoying being comforted in her husband's arms. He wasn't sure she was asleep, but she had become very quiet and her breaths came slow and steady. He shifted his eyes to watch her face; eyes closed, lips parted as she made light snoring sounds...

Now he eased forward, let her slip from his shoulder to peer over her body. Renny lay behind his wife on his back. Buck naked like he said; from the porch light coming through the window, Nelson could see the highlights of his trim stomach and the cup of his navel, then the thick tangle of his pubic hair. And his penis lay flat across his hip, the big head of it near his hip bone, pointing toward Natalie.

Natalie stirred with his movement and moved her arms to hug him a little more closely. He settled down, put his head back in the pillow and looked at the ceiling again; hoping upon hope that her arm wouldn't drift down too far and her elbow tap the point of his rock hard erection.

Chapter 9

Nelson was restless. She clung herself to him, trying to get as close as possible so she was creating distance between her and the guy behind her. After a long while, she'd grown complacent and even drifted off. Nothing was happening. It was all bullshit, anyway. Renny saying that dumb stuff about Nelson.

But there was no way Nelson wasn't thinking about it now; wondering if something had happened between his wife and Renny last year. Why is Natalie so mad? Why is she acting so weird? Why didn't she tear her nails down Renny's face when he slipped a finger underneath the edge of her panty trim—Jesus, Nelson, he touched my pussy! Nelson wasn't dumb. That's why she clung to him. That's why she nuzzled her cheek on him. The best thing in her life on one side, and the worst thing behind her. She'd prefer to leave it behind her.

Renny stirred. She jostled on the air mattress as his weight shifted behind her. Her ears pricked up, attuned to what he was doing. She began to chew the corner of the inside of her mouth with her canines. Her eyes opened, turned up to Nelson. He was asleep. Eyes closed, breathing deeply.

Renny was shifting. This was it. She knew it.

She moved up and down on the air mattress again and could tell that Renny was moving closer. She brought her elbow close to her waist, ready to protect herself; closing herself off.

Then he was moving, and she turned her cheek a quarter inch to hear better what he might be doing. There was a tap-tapping at the top of her thigh, just below the trim of her panties and below the edge of her flannel shirt.

Renny tapping her...

She turned her head another quarter inch to say, “Quit it.” A soft whisper that wouldn’t wake Nelson, but tinged with enough vitriol the guy would get the message.

Tap-tap again. A very light, boneless feel against her skin. Now she knew what it was...

Her elbow shot back and clipped him in the ribs and then her hand whipped down, forming a claw ready to clutch what he’d tapped her with. Big enough it was easy to find, she grabbed a hold of his dick mid-shaft and squeezed him hard. She could hear him chuckle, and it made her squeeze even harder. He flexed his cock and she could feel it squirming in her grip; the muscles of her forearm trembled. Now he hissed, and his body weight shifted toward her. She pulled on it. Pulled as hard as she could on his dick, looking down her body and seeing the huge thing in her hand. Stretched thin from the heel to his pubic hair, and then past her thumb a fat wrinkled bulb of gathered tissue. She twisted her hand, wrenched his penis, and it got him surrendering, saying, “Ow, Nat, Nat, Nat...”

She hissed exactly as she did before: “Quit it.”

“Let it go,” Renny whispered.

She tugged on it one more time to remind him she meant business before releasing it. But he didn’t move away, and she was still mad—she whacked her fingers between his legs, trying to injure his testicles. It made him laugh again, but at least he backed away a little.

“Come on, Natty,” he whispered.

“Get out of here,” she said, then put her hand on Nelson’s chest again and kissed him over his heart.

Renny’s hand moved along her back; she could imagine his index finger knuckle bent and stroking down over her spine then slipping below the covers. He touched her at the seam of her thighs just above her knees and she jumped. Her hand shot back again, punched him near his penis.

“Come on, Nat. Don’t be like that,” he said, and she could hear the malicious mirth in his voice. Restraining laughter like the fucking asshole he was. Thinking this was funny.

When his hand moved a little higher, she kicked him in the shin with a heel. When his hand kept touching her, she did it again. But it got the bed jumping and Nelson stirred. She remained still for a moment, eyes turned up to watch her husband.

Renny’s hand stroked a little higher, came to caress the globe of one of her buttocks. He tucked a finger under her panty trim and straightened them, tugged them out of her creases.

She said, “What’s your obsession with my panties?”

“It’s what’s under them...”

She turned her eyes up again to watch Nelson. Saw that he was still unconscious. She eased out of the crook of his shoulder, moved off his arm. She took his wrist and lay his hand over his stomach. Renny was caressing her ass again.

She was careful when she rolled over, wary of disturbing Nelson. Behind her, she found Renny completely naked. Laying with his hips square, his huge cock over one leg, he was on an elbow and looking at her.

She said, “Can you go to the couch?”

“I don’t want to go to the couch.”

“Why not?... It’s so fucking hot in here...”

“You want me here.”

“I don’t fucking want you here, Renny, you idiot. Get over on the fucking couch...”

“Come on, Nat,” he said, “you know what’s happening...” Now his hand touched the front of her thigh and she kicked him in the shin again, this

time hurting her toe. She heard it make a pop.

That made Renny laugh. "Serves you right."

"Don't fucking touch me," she said.

Renny said, "Nat, you're being crazy."

"You're being fucking crazy, asshole," she said, a little too aggressively, and it got the air mattress moving again.

Renny said, "Keep your voice down."

"You keep your voice down."

"I am."

"Good."

He touched one of the open ends of her flannel shirt and pushed it away, looking at the shape of her breasts under the T-shirt. He said, "Take this off, Nat. You're sweating like a pig."

"You're the fucking pig."

"Take it off, Nat."

She slapped his hand away. Now the bed was bouncing again. She was propped up on an elbow like he was, both of them facing each other. She craned her neck around to look at Nelson. Still on his back, face turned up to the ceiling and eyes closed.

That's when Renny touched her pussy over her panties. She made a quick hissing sound and shot her chin around to look at him. She could see the highlights of his face painted in daubs of amber light from the porch. Snow still fluttered out the window in the square panes, over the backdrop of white-laden evergreen boughs. The tip of his middle finger caressed the cleft of her mound and her mouth fell open. Quietly as she could, she said, "Stop."

But Renny didn't, she could see his cheek pull back and knew he was smiling as he touched her.

"I'm serious."

He still didn't heed her, stroking down the center of her panties into the warmth of her split, stroking back up again, touching the top of her thigh and curling his finger underneath the cotton trim. He slipped his finger lower, she parted her knees for him. She said, "I'm warning you."

His smile came wider; she could see a dimple in his cheek.

Now the tip of his finger was stroking over her labia, feeling slick as oil. There were crackling wet sounds in the quiet room, she moaned softly and swallowed it. She turned her chin up to the ceiling and gripped her own neck. Renny teased with two fingers, slipping them back and forth then withdrawing his hand. When he didn't touch her anymore her anger returned; her chin came down, and she looked at him—knew that her face was lit up by the porch light and wanted to show him she meant business. She scowled.

He touched her lip with the middle finger he'd had between her legs. She could smell her own lubrication on him. He ran his slippery fingers over her bottom lip, guided them into her mouth and she sucked on them. He eased her head to tilt back, slowly fucked her mouth with his pussy-coated middle fingers. Then she bit down, not hard; held their thrusting at bay; made a low threatening growl.

He withdrew them, put them in his own mouth and she groaned and tightened her core. Thighs clamped tight together, her scowl contorted into a slow, puzzled frown. She settled back to lay with her head on the pillow, then rolled over to face Nelson again, but her eyes wouldn't close. They were wide and blinking.

When the tapping returned, this time she put her hand down with care. Renny's penis's tapping had more weight this time; when she put her hand on it, she could feel how rubbery he had become. His thing was enormous. She gripped it in the middle and stroked it...



Nelson could hear Natalie's quiet voice say to Renny: "Just go to the couch already."

She'd been moving around, and he knew they were up to something. Now when he looked down, he could see Natalie's knees bent, touching the side of his leg, and there at the top of her thigh, over the curve of her hip: Renny's huge, hard cock. Natalie stroked it, grip unsure and clumsy, Renny's thing not yet hard but big and rubbery. She was doing it slow, reluctant. Hating doing what she was doing, but doing it anyway. With her hand she was encouraging him to get hard, with her mouth she was telling him he needed to leave. Telling him he shouldn't be here. It was because she couldn't trust herself and she knew it. It was powerful. His heart was racing, and he hoped Natalie wouldn't put her head to his chest again because she would certainly hear it and know her husband was not sleeping at all.

"I'm serious, Renny," she whispered, "please, go to the couch."

Renny's low voice: "You don't want me on the couch."

"Please, I do. Go sleep on the couch..."

"I like it here, Nat," he said, and Nelson knew that he was rubbing her waist.

He tucked his chin down a little to get a better view of what they were doing. Natalie still gripped his cock, the thing getting very straight looking now; less flopping around. Renny indeed lay a hand over Nat's waist. She pushed Renny's erection downward, like she wanted to get rid of it—only Nelson knew that the thing was now pressing up between her legs. He could see her hips swivel and Renny was probably pushing it between her thighs.

Natalie's legs opened, her knees coming apart, and now Renny's cock showed against the inside of her thigh. She slipped a hand down her front, going over her pussy, teasing the tip of his cock head with her two middle fingers. "Oh my God," she whispered, "just get out of here..."

Renny's hand appeared on her hip, pushing her flannel shirt out of the way, shoving a thumb under the curve of her panties. He pushed them down her hip, and now she let his cock go and grabbed at the front of her panties. She hissed, "Don't!" Renny persisted, pushing harder on her pants, and Natalie pulling up equally hard until there was a tearing-stitch sound. "Please don't," she said.

Renny used two hands now, one at the back, curled over her butt, the other forcing them down at her hip. They rolled down, turning inside out. "Don't," she hissed again and kicked him.

"Careful," Renny said, "you'll wake Nelson."

"I should wake Nelson."

"Go ahead."

They were silent for a long moment, Natalie looking over her shoulder at him.

He said, "But you won't."

"I will if you don't stop."

"I welcome it," he said, and pushed down on her panties again, getting them almost to her knees. Natalie still struggled, and kept her legs clamped together, lamely using her hands to keep them from being pulled right down. She said, "You're jostling the bed..."

"Then stop struggling," he said.

She said, "Don't take my panties off."

He said, "How'm I going to fuck you then?"

“You’re not. Go to the couch.”

“Come on, Nat,” he said soothingly, his hand letting her panties go for a moment to caress the outside of her thigh, slipping around to the front. Nelson was sure he stroked her between her legs. Natalie made a soft moaning sound.

Then she punched him in the dick. Nelson could see her small, clenched fist come down, hear the wet smack, could see Renny’s huge stiff cock bouncing and wagging.

Renny laughed, whispered, “I like it.”

“You’re such an asshole...”

“Natty, Natty,” he said, and pushed down on her panties again. Using both hands, he got them to her knees, then sat up and Nelson could see his black silhouette against the lit sky. He watched as his good buddy with his big dick sat with the thing sticking straight up in his lap, tugging and sliding his wife’s panties off her legs and over her feet. Now she drew up her knees to protect herself, but it exposed her pussy from behind.

Renny sucked four fingers, and they disappeared behind Natalie’s rump. She drew her knees up higher and made a soft gasping sound. Soon there was wet, slick, smacking sounds between her legs as Renny teased her with his fingers stroking up and down, maybe sliding one or two inside her...

Chapter 10

Nelson said, “What are you guys doing?”

Natalie stiffened against him, he heard a croaking sound in her throat. She creaked, “What do you mean?”

He said, “You keep bouncing the bed.”

“No, we’re not...”

“Sure we are,” Renny said.

“Go back to sleep, Nelson,” Natalie said.

He eased up on his elbows, looked around sleepily, putting the act on.

Natalie snuggled closer against him, rubbed his stomach. “Go back to sleep, baby.”

“It’s so hot in here,” he said.

Renny said, “You’re telling me. I’m sleeping naked.”

Natalie squeezed her arm around Nelson’s waist.

Renny said, “And your wife can’t stop touching my dick.”

Before he even had a chance to make an exclamation—as theatrical as it may be—Natalie let him go, sitting up now and twisting at the waist, her fist coming down and punching Renny on the chest. In the light from the window, Nelson could clearly see Renny’s huge erection up over his stomach. It was so obvious, Natalie would have seen it too. So he took the opportunity: “You have a hard on?”

Renny laughed. “I told you, Nelson. Natalie keeps touching it—”

Before he even finished, he drew his knees up before Natalie would punch him in the testicles.

She hissed, “You’re such a fucking asshole. What are you talking about?” She thumped him again with the heel of her fist. “Nelson, he’s fucking lying...”

Nelson gave the concerned father voice: “What’s been going on here?”

“Nothing, nothing. Don’t listen to him...”

Renny was still laughing, and he put a hand out and stroked up Natalie’s thigh. He said, “I got into bed here, and I was trying to sleep, but your wife keeps touching my dick.”

Now Natalie was in a rage. She got up onto her knees and spun around to face Renny. She said, “I want you to get the fuck out of here,” and Nelson could hear through her anger a sobbing being held back from her voice. “I mean it, get the fuck out of here.”

“Easy, Nat...” Renny said, but Natalie wasn’t done.

She loomed over him, hands clenched in fists. “I’m serious, Renny—you get out of here, go back to that fucking bar.”

“How?” he laughed and put up his hands in surrender. Light shone off his teeth showing off his big smile. He was loving this.

Nelson said, “You were doing this when I was sleeping?”

Now Natalie softened, turned to look at him. He could see her shoulders slump and her fists relax. She whispered, “No. He’s lying...”

Renny said, “I’m just kidding, Nelson.”

Natalie put both hands over her face and wiped at her eyes. Nelson reached over and stroked her bare thigh. He said, “Why does he get to you so bad?”

“He doesn’t,” she moaned thickly into her palms.

“I think I do,” Renny said, and he put his hand on her other thigh.

She sniffed and slapped at his hand. “Don’t touch me.”

Renny withdrew his hand, but then it returned, touching her thigh. “It’s okay, Nat. Don’t be mad. Everything’s all right.”

Nelson stopped stroking her thigh, turned up the heat. “Natalie—are you not wearing any panties...?”

Now she did make a sobbing sort of noise, and both her hands fell between her legs, curled up weakly, gathered in the sheets. She said, “No. It’s hot...”

Renny said, “It is hot. You should take off that shirt,” and he reached to tug one of the open halves of her flannel. This time she didn’t bat his hand away.

Now he stroked her thigh again, starting in the middle and then slipping higher. Natalie sniffed, wiped at her nose, and now Nelson could see her head turned to look at him. Fiery light from the cook room behind them reflected in her eye, and he could see his wife watching him and blinking. Renny’s hand moved higher still, squeezing past her gathered wrists and touching between her legs. Renny sat up a little higher, grinning. Both guys watching Natalie now, and Natalie bewildered. Her mouth fell open to say something, but no words came out. Renny’s fingers brought slick sounds from between her legs now and Natalie’s eyes fluttered. She sighed, “Nelson, why don’t you stop him?”

Nelson looked at Renny, looked down to where his hand worked between his wife’s legs, said, “That’s up to you, Natalie.”

Natalie’s hands moved to hold Renny’s wrist. She said, “I don’t think you should do that.”

Renny said, “Your pussy doesn’t think I should stop...”

“Please, don’t,” she said.

Renny sat up, getting close to her so he could study her face while he fingered her. He bit her shoulder, smiling, his eyes turned up to watch her expression. Natalie sighed, turned her chin up and closed her eyes. The wet sounds grew more pronounced between her legs.

Natalie said, “Nelson, please stop him...”

“You’re on your own,” he said. And now Renny was pushing against Natalie with his shoulder, guiding her so she lay on her back with her knees up and her legs open. Nelson could see that the guy had two fingers inside her, slick and shiny, pulsing in and out of her. He lifted her undershirt and kissed above her navel. Worked his mouth down toward where his fingers were pushing inside her and gave her a few kisses in her pubic hair.

She said, “Nelson, don’t let him do this to me...”

Renny got to his knees, took her hand and put it on his erection while he still fucked her with his fingers. She squeezed his cock but didn’t stroke, then she rolled away like she would crawl across the bed to get away from him, but he grabbed one of her ankles and pulled her back. She sunk onto her tummy, and he got between her knees. Then she pushed her bare ass up in the air, getting on her knees and elbows and presenting to Renny her womanhood...



The motor of her heart blazed in the red zone; her mind raced as her eardrums filled with the explosive whoosh-whoosh of her overworked heart. Things she could feel: her husband’s eyes on her; Renny’s hot hands on her waist; the warm and slick crabapple cock head pushing into her sticky seam. At once she wanted to feel herself fully impaled by this hung guy she hated. To have him dominate her with his organ like he’d done a year ago. Completely claim her insides; make her cry out—but at the same

time she wanted to start kicking her legs, thrashing her arms, screaming and yelling, hoof open the cabin door and run into the cold, snowy night. Nothing made sense; madness and unreality swirled around her like she'd been doing cartwheels and ended up ass-over-teakettle on the lawn, bewildered and dizzy.

She lunged forward, grabbed handfuls of sheets in her fists. She pulled them toward herself like she was climbing a rope ladder—had this been a normal bed, she could've shimmied her way into the pillows and hid from them, but this was a dumb air mattress in a too hot cabin in the middle of nowhere, and the sheets were untucked and just tugged under her. She wasn't going anywhere.

She collapsed onto her belly again, tried to bring her knees together but Renny was between them. She gathered up blankets and sheets to her chest and squirmed. Hips still square and flat on the air mattress, she got her shoulders twisted enough she looked up and saw Nelson watching her blankly. Expressionless. Blinking. She said, "Don't let him do it."

"It's just you and him here," he said.

"No, Nelson," she sighed. Renny pressed his body over hers, his huge cock probing up the insides of her thighs, looking for her seam, wanting to sink himself in her as badly as she wanted him to do it. "No, Nelson," she said again.

Now Nelson smiled and instead of coaxing one out of her in simpatico, she frowned, her brow coming down so low she squinted. Her husband cupped her cheek and stroked the corner of her mouth with his thumb. He said, "I'm not even here..."

Renny was easing his weight off her body again, hunching down between her spread legs. He bit her ass cheek. She kicked him with her heel. "Don't you dare," she said. "Nelson! Nelson, don't let him..."

"You stop me, Nat," Renny said, smiling then spanking her bottom. She brought her knees up to her ribs, squatting in a weird, hunched frog-shape in the middle of the air mattress. Renny took advantage of the vulgar

exposure: stroking his hand up her wetness, obliterating her resolve for a moment.

He said, "Listen how wet she is for me, Nelson, listen to her little hole slurp my finger..."

Then she was tumbling, curling into a ball to get away from him. Renny grabbed her knee; she was on her back now, Renny trying to open her legs. She slapped him across the face, but he only smiled. "Nelson," she said again. Then Nelson had her wrist. She struggled against him, trying to get away, but he held her fast. With her free left hand, she swatted at Renny, her hand turned to a claw. Renny grabbed that wrist and held it. Now she looked between them, wide-eyed and frightened. What was happening?

Nelson got close to her ear, his other hand snaking around over her head to take her other wrist from Renny. Now her husband held both of them. He said, "I'm going to hold you down while he fucks you. Tell me you don't want it."

"Nelson, I don't want to..."

Slowly the grip on her wrists lessened, and she pulled free from his grasp. She got up on her elbows, Renny there on his knees between her legs, his balls hanging above her hairy mound, his huge cock sticking straight out and slightly upright, listing to one side. It throbbed with excitement, light zipped along its raised edges and veins, and the plump coronal ridge of the fat cock head. She said, "What is going on?"

Nelson held her wrist again. He kissed her temple. She struggled lamely against his grip but he held her still. She could pull free if she wanted. She said, "What's he going to do to me?"

Nelson whispered, "He's going to fuck you."

"But I can't stand him..."

Renny laughed, scratched his stomach looking down on her.

Nelson whispered, “That’s why it’s so-oo hot.”

“I don’t want him to...”

Renny smiled wide and bit his lower lip. The scratching hand on his stomach slid down and pressed the top side of his cock. He pushed it downward, angling his hips so he stroked over her mound with the underside of the head of his cock. She couldn’t help wriggling her hips, watching the huge, sexy shape of his plump helmet press and rub over her slippery folds.

Renny said, “Tell me you don’t want it.”

She gasped, “Nelson, why are you doing this?”

He bit her earlobe. “For you. I’m doing it for you because I love you.”

Now her eyes were on Renny, smirking down on her with his sexy body rippling in the low, dull amber porch light. She could see the drawings up his arms, the medallions on leather strips around his neck. He was lean and hard, and so fucking sexy. His cock was pushed down, wanting to penetrate her. She humped her hips upward, tilting and stroking to make his arousal brush against her opening.

“That’s my Natalie,” Renny said, and eased the head of his cock inside her. Her mouth fell open, and she arched her back. “That’s my favorite little cock slut,” he groaned as he slid himself deeper inside her...



Nelson held his wife’s wrists, stroking his thumbs over the insides where faint blue veins traced. His beautiful loving and amazing wife. There wasn’t a person on this planet he loved more. Couldn’t love more. She was

everything to him and he would be with her until he was dead. There was no way she could hurt him. Deep down despite things she might do he could feel her love for him. It wasn't fake. It was profound; like they were soul mates. "Take it, Nat," he said, kissing her hairline above her ear.

"I'm not a cock slut," she moaned.

When he pulled back, she made a long, low sound of powerful lust.

Renny said, "What you call it when you want this cock so bad...?" He slid back in, and any smart-ass answer she had was extinguished as she made a soft whimper and bit her lower lip.

Nelson kissed her cheek now. She wasn't struggling in his grasp, wasn't trying to push Renny away; she liked being held. Liked submitting to this guy she couldn't stand. Liked her husband offering her up; it removed her agency. It gave her an explanation for her powerlessness. Because the truth was she didn't need her husband's permission. She had a ten-cylinder power-stroke diesel motor inside her that burned hot and hungry for fuel. A lust so powerful that despite all her power she was useless at resisting Renny's appeal. So Nelson offered up for his wife the reason her resolve failed. It was his fault; blame Nelson.

Now he watched down his wife's body, past her the shape of her unhitched bra clumping under her undershirt, her soft breasts still straining against the fabric, the soft smooth and round belly, at the apex her thick thatch of wiry pubic hair. He could see Renny's dark and wide manhood pushing inside her. Could hear the sounds of his wife's sticky membranes being stretched apart to accommodate him. Could see a slight tremor in the creamy skin of his wife's smooth thighs spread open for this other man.

Renny said, "You miss this cock? You think about it?"

Now her wrist ripped from his grasp and she smacked Renny clumsily on his face, and her hands turned to claws trying to scratch at his chest with her nails. Renny laughed, thrust himself deep, and it curled her hand uselessly. Renny grabbed her wrist, withdrew and plunged back in again.

She said, “Shut the fuck up, you asshole...”

“I bet you did. I bet you thought about it all year...”

Nat was stiffening, still thinking she could hide the fact that she cheated on him already. That what was happening here on this bed was new. That her husband didn’t know the truth. He shushed her and soothed her, whispering silky noises near her ear.

She said, “I never think about you...”

Renny withdrew, plunged deeper. “Well shit,” he said. “A lot of nights I didn’t have some chick in the back room with me, I thought about you...”

“Don’t talk,” she hissed. “Shut your big mouth...”

“My big mouth?” he said. “You’re the one with the big mouth.”

Now she was squirming out of Nelson’s grip but he held her still. She tried sitting up, but Renny pushed her back and thrust himself deep inside her. She cried out, grabbed his arms and clawed him.

He said, “You got a big mouth, Nat, and you know what you want me to put in it.”

She struggled under him, trying to form an argument but just making deep guttural sounds and gasping. Renny kissed at her neck, gripped her throat with a hand and eased her face toward him. But she wouldn’t kiss his mouth, tugged her face away from him, batted at him with her hands. “Don’t fucking kiss me. Just shut up and fuck me...”

Chapter 11

Renny's face made her want to slap it, punch it, dig her nails in and squeeze until her fists shook. She wanted to destroy him, wanted him not to exist, but he made himself very apparent to her, his presence was undeniable.

He slid himself inside her body, into the place that was meant only for her husband once they'd stood on the altar at St. Mike's church in that village in the north end of the city, signed the paperwork and donned their golden rings before they jetted off to Costa Rica for two weeks. Signed and sealed and promised forever. The inside of her body was only for her husband. But Renny was claiming it. More than claiming it, he was dominating it. Making it his own, spreading her tight walls out to their furthest reaches. Deeper and deeper, until she had nowhere else to go, until she could only hitch her knees higher and submit complete and total ownership. It was wrong and wild and salacious, but it was pure crazy pleasure. A feeling like she'd only had one time before in her whole life. A horrible evening almost one year ago where she surrendered to a man because of what he had between his legs. Only tonight, her husband was with her, holding her hands back, though were she honest, she put up very little fight. It was for show, her arms struggling weakly against her husband's meager grasp. She wasn't fooling him. She wasn't fooling Renny. Who was she trying to fool?

"Okay, let go, let me go," she said, ready to submit and to admit.

When he sunk deeper—his handsome, arrogant face getting closer over hers—his cock stretched her little opening until it hurt. "Ow, ow," she exclaimed, and when he stopped she said, "Keep going, don't stop..." Irritated with him.

Renny sunk himself deeper, withdrew and did it over again; a feeling so incredible she felt like she was falling over backwards through the air, out of a plane into the warm tropics, weightless for a moment but plummeting to certain doom. It would be fun while it lasted...

She hissed with hate: “God, fuck, it’s so good...”

Nelson near her ear: “Take it, Nat, take it...”

She squeaked: “Why?”

“Because you want it...”

“I don’t,” she lied, and Renny chuckled. And proved his point; he thrust deeper still, pulling back almost instantly. It made her squeal and jump and both Renny and her husband laughed at her. “Don’t,” she moaned.

“Take it, Nat. Take it because you want it...”

“She totally wants it,” Renny said. “Listen to that pussy speak...”

“You’re such an animal,” she said, and batted at his face weakly, her clenched hands pounding where his neck met his collar.

“And look at that face,” Renny said. “Look at that face on her, hoo, Natalie loves it...”

“Fuck off,” she said, and now she hid her face in her hands.

Renny withdrew and thrust again, going deeper still. He was so hard, so large, the head of his cock felt like a rubber ball passing through her guts. The pleasure was intense; a sexual heat like she’d felt only once before. His large size stretched her out and stroked all her forbidden places

Renny was saying in a hoarse whisper: “Nelson... Hey, Nelson...”

And now she looked up to see the man who was penetrating her looking at her husband, and her husband watching Renny to see what he wanted; the two of them together in this...

Renny said, “Undo her stupid hair, she looks like Princess Leia...”

“You don’t wanna fuck Princess Leia?” she spat.

His hips pummeled her, driving that rod deep into her. She squawked.

He bore down on her, his asshole face looming over hers, sneering, loving to see her spread out for him. He said, “I want to fuck Natalie Stacks.”

“Then fuck her, you piece of shit,” she said through gritted teeth, seething.

“That’s Natalie Stacks,” he said, a triumphant smile dimpling his cheeks.

“That’s who I came to fuck...”

His hips began a magical dance, swiveling, thrusting, drawing circles. His long, thick cock squirmed inside her, spreading her canal but pushing that plump cock head in new plunging strokes that had its round shape drawing swabs of pleasure over her tight pink insides. He had her singing, making all sorts of warbling sounds of uncontrollable pleasure.

Nelson had shimmied behind her and she hadn’t noticed, but now his hands undid her braids while his old roommate fucked her good and steady and deep. The crown of her head rolled against a hard column and she knew it was her husband’s erection.

Nelson’s thighs were on either side of her head, her ears rocking from side to side between them; her husband bracing her while another man fucked her. Renny had been right? How was it possible? How could Renny be right? There was no way; not her Nelson. Here and now was one thing—but he couldn’t know about last year, he just couldn’t...

But now Nelson had the front of her T-shirt, leaning over her body, pulling it up. She had a strange urge to grab it and thrust it down—don’t flash Renny! But Renny was fucking her. Her hands had grabbed at his wrists, but she released them. Nelson pulled up the front of her shirt, taking her bra and flannel as he went; baring her chest to Renny who would be watching.

Renny growled, “Oh, look at those tits, Nat, so big, so natural...” His hands went to them and she didn’t fight it. Nelson pulled the shirts free and ran his hands through her untangled hair to spread it out.

Renny was over her, raised up so he could look at her while he fucked her and squeezed her tits. He sneered. “With your greasy hair, on your back like a dumb slut, you’re nothing more than those girls I fuck on the road, Nat. Ones you look down on. You make six-figs and you’re a boss but you’re still just a pink hole waiting to get fucked.”



It put his wife in a growling rage; she sneered and scowled, hissed through clenched teeth; but instead of lashing out and trying to claw Renny’s eyes, now instead she fucked him back. Hurling her hips against his, knees coming up to her ears, her soft little tummy bowled out, her navel a quivering cup filling with sweat. Her hips bucked, her rump bouncing off the mattress as she thrust herself against his thrusts, locking eyes with him and making a steam engine sound of hate.

Natalie could pretend all she wanted, but her armor was falling away, the leather straps keeping it together crumbling, rotting, letting plates of hard-ass armor fall uselessly, clattering to the floor. Renny’s size stripped his wife bare. Took away all her bravado, all her feminine machismo and dashed it to the floor. Renny turned his bold big-mouth wife into a quivering woman. Turned her into a Victorian harlot with four skirts hoisted up over her head getting plowed; Lady Chatterley’s lover with her knees up in her ears. A sight he thought he would hate if you asked him two years ago. And yet one there was no denying set off his love rockets; all engines burning and firing, all systems flashing green as his own lust lit up with enough fuel to shoot him into orbit. Seeing his wife like this was crazy beautiful. His love for her was bottomless. His respect for her was enormous. To see her given this gift of freedom was a joyous thing. Something to celebrate. Last year had been amazing, but it missed one thing: togetherness. That’s what was missing. Watching his wife cheat and all the thrills and spectacle of his wanton woman stripped bare were

incredible—but he couldn't hold her hand while she did it. So now he would enjoy it, do it with her. Hold her hand while this guy who she couldn't spend two minutes talking to without fighting did their own kind of combat. Sorted out their differences with their sexual parts engorged and wet and crashing against each other.

Whatever it was between them, he was fearless. And seeing them together like this brought an astounding arousal of his own. His cock was hard like an iron bar, poking out the front of his shorts right now. He wished he had what Renny had so he could do to his wife what his old friend was doing to her now. Surrendering, that dominant Natalie spirit being choked out, suffocating and submitting to male dominance. No one could do it to her. But Renny could. One man had the power to get over top of her and make her beg like this.

Natalie's hands curled over the backs of her thighs just above her knees, hoisting her legs higher so Renny would have better access. Her calves bobbed while he fucked her. She held her legs up and open, head thrust back in his lap and baring her teeth; opening and closing her mouth. He had her squeaks coming fast and rapid. On his knees, spread out wide, his huge cock pushed in and out of her.

He pulled it out and slapped it over the gathered meat of her sex. She babbled and moaned, loving to feel the weight of his tool slapping on her button but wanting him inside again.

"Fuck me, Renny, don't stop..."

"I'm going to, Nat," he said, tapping and circling his cock head on her shining folds. "I'm going to fuck the shit out of your sloppy, hairy beaver. I'm going to pummel it, skin it, turn it inside out and Nelson's going to wear it home as a floppy hat."

She growled again, humped her hips, looking to get his thing inside her again. She said, "With that sub-85 IQ cock? That big, dumb cock that sits at the back of class breathing through its mouth?"

Renny loomed over her, hate-fucking her with his eyes while his cock's belly stroked up and down her sticky seam. "One you dream about when you're in bed at night? Bet you draw pictures of it in your notebook." He grabbed a handful of her hair close to her scalp and she squawked.

She covered his hand with hers, digging her nails in, trying to take the pressure off his grip. She hissed, "You're such an idiot."

Hips drawn back, his throbbing bulb fell into her juicy opening and he speared her deep with one hard thrust. Natalie cried out and Renny twisted his hand tighter in her hair. Now his hips were driving up and down, his rump rising and falling, Natalie's acceptance of his huge size coming with sounds of slick squelching.

Now she was looking up at Renny, still baring her teeth and her eyes wide and gaping. Her face froze in wild excitement at the pleasure he was giving her. But instead of encouragement she shot more vitriol: "You dumb fucking animal..."

With the pads of the four fingers of his free hand, he slapped and beat over her hairy mound, then ran his thumb in hard circles pushing down onto her button. It got Natalie's legs shaking and jumping and her cries turned to screams.

She wailed, "You're nothing more than a big cock..."

Renny growled, "I wish I had another cock I could shove in your dumb slut mouth, shut you the fuck up."

Natalie craned her neck to get close, looking in his eyes and spitting, "Then choke me, you piece of shit."

Renny didn't need to be asked twice. His hands shot to her collar, opened and smoothed around her thin neck, closing and squeezing.

A vein rose in Natalie's neck in three pumps of her heart and her face went red; her eyes widened, and she bared her teeth at him again, snorting breath through them, blowing a bubble in the gap of her canines. Her hands snaked

up Renny's arms and Renny chuckled, raising his shoulders to protect his neck; but Nat grabbed handfuls of his hair above his temples and tugged him. He growled, let his grip slack, and they both snorted and made sounds of violence in their throats, fucking still, and grappling with each other.

Renny reared up, pulling Nat with him as her hands locked on his hair, roaring. His cock shoved deep and Natalie cried out, Renny's grip loosening enough to allow her some air. Nelson sat back on his heels and watched with his eyebrows high, his eyes wide. His scalp tingled with electricity seeing his wife have sex like he'd never seen before. It looked more like fighting; only he knew Renny was hard, and she was wet, and he was fully impaled inside her. They looked like a nature documentary.

Natalie was squeaking now, high-pitched air blurts in her throat, bleating like a leaky balloon.

Renny was mad, hands on her throat again and shaking her, making her head loll. He was spitting, "Don't you come, don't you dare. You come when I say you come, you cunt..."

Nelson sank heavily on his heels; his eyebrows couldn't raise any higher and his breath couldn't hitch any tighter. No one talked to Nat like that.

"Don't you come," Renny was saying again, low and mean, letting Nat down to lay on her back, her mouth opening and closing like a dying fish; Nelson was convinced she was coming.

Natalie's breath wailed in sudden gulps, her back heaving, Renny stroking her collar, coddling her heavy breasts. "Too late, huh? Nat got that nut."

Natalie tried to zip him back, her mouth worked to form words, but she just whispered vowels. Renny's hips slowed, but still rode against her, Nat's body rocking, breasts swaying.

Renny said, "Let's get this five-dollar hooker on all fours."

"Five... huh, five dollars...?" Natalie croaked then panted, her breaths coming deep and fast, "hope, ha, hope you've, ho, been saving up..." But

she was rolling over lazily, heavily, exhausted. One knee came up, her hips fell over then she got on her elbows and raised her rump up.

Renny slapped her ass cheek hard, said, “Nelson’s paying.”

His wife crouched in his lap between his open legs, her cheek resting against the belly of his powerful arousal. He stroked her hair and cupped a palm over the back of her sweet head.

Renny gripped his tool with one fist and beat it over Nat’s bent over ass cheeks, lined it up then sunk it deep. He could feel his wife’s bellow against his scrotum. Renny held her waist and began fucking her hard again.

“Nelson, Nelson,” Renny said, snapping his attention away. He looked up to see the guy watching him, wanting to show him something.

“What?”

Nelson backed away and Nat lay her head down, shoulder buried in the pillows, and turned to watch what Renny would do. She folded an arm under her head, tangled hair wrapping through her fingers. Her other hand came down to grab her own ass cheek and open the space between her thighs.

Renny said, “Get down here and watch this. You wanted to see this? Don’t hide in the shadows anymore...”

Nelson scooted down, sitting beside where they were connected. He arrived in time to see the huge glans of his friend’s cock press into his wife’s eager opening. Her membranes spread for it, clung to his girth, but swallowed him eagerly. Renny sunk three-quarters of his length inside her and Natalie made a sound of joy. He clenched her wrist, and Natalie’s hand on her buttock turned to a claw, fingertips pressing into her soft womanly flesh.

Renny pounded her and Nelson watched only the spot where their sex parts collided. Natalie’s poor, beaten, rosy-pink membranes clinging and plunging with Renny’s huge girth as he drove it in and out of her in a steady rhythm that had his balls dancing below. Natalie groaned and cried with

each thrust, whimpered when he went too deep, and the whole time Nelson's eyes were glued to that thin pink part of her sucking on Renny's massive size. The thing was shining, gleaming, Natalie's wet showing off all its ridges and bumps and veins.

Renny's thumb slid now over her anus, teased it, sunk inside; Natalie never looked more beautiful. He watched her face, watched the pleasure rough hard sex with a huge cock did to her. Watched his wife's face peel and contort, watched her gasp and cry as she was pummeled between her legs with a thumb in her ass.

Renny flubbed, his stroke getting too ambitious, withdrawing too far, and the thing popped out and bounced and flopped against her ass cheek and Natalie made a moaning desperate sound wanting it back inside her. He grabbed it and shoved it back in, gripped her wrist tighter now, pounded her harder... It went on like that, pounding and pounding and Natalie making all kinds of crazy sounds. Then she began a frantic crying, a wailing, saying, "Oh God, oh God," and now her eyes were open, locked on Renny's.

He was saying, "You want that, you want that cock...?"

She was saying, "Give it, give it harder, harder... don't stop, don't stop..."

He said, "Your pussy can take it..."

She said, "I can take it, harder, harder, don't stop, oh, it's coming..." Natalie slipped her hand over her rump, spread the v of her first two fingers on either side of Renny's huge cock, saying now, "God, it's so fucking wide, oh, so fucking wide it's ripping me open..."

"Look at that thing cling to me, Nelson, fuck, Nat, you've got the tightest snatch..."

"It's so thick," she cried.

"Tell me, Nat, tell me..." Nelson said.

"Tell your husband, Natty, tell him how you love it..."

“Ah, mm, I love it, I love it...”

“It’s big?” Nelson asked

She snorted and moaned, “Oh my God, so fucking big, so fucking good...
oh no, oh, it’s, mm, I’m, ah...”

Chapter 12

Bewildered, someone pulled on her arm and she rolled on to her back, putting her knees up, wanting Renny to shove that thing right back deep inside her. Vision warbled, she blinked to see Renny reaching for her wrists and leading her to get up on her knees. He was falling back, his cock pointing up then slapping down across his hip. She let him lead her, holding her hands as she straddled his thighs. Now he took his cock—fuck, it shone like it was dipped in oil, was that from her insides?—and batted her between the legs, his heavy dick bapping her on her nest of wet, wrinkled sex, each little blat shooting bright white in her vision. “Put it in me,” she said, “don’t tease me, just give me that cock.”

Her opening was like a live uninsulated wire connected directly to the ticklish pleasure-center of her brain. The soft membranes between her legs hungry and eager to be used and abused and spread open. Every time he touched her with that thing her heart fluttered and her brain did a funny loop-the-loop.

Her head lolled back on her shoulders, her eyes doing this flickering thing, her mouth falling open... She put her hands out behind her to support herself before she fell, walked her fingers until she had her hands curled over Renny’s legs just above his knees.

Now she could look down between her legs spread open over Renny’s thighs; his dick looked enormous, wet and ready. She tilted her hips and Renny was just as eager as she was, pushing his butt down into the air mattress making them both jostle, but finding the right angle and distance to run that thing through her wet flesh and shove it deep inside her. She met his thrust too, rolling her pelvis down to get as much of him inside her as she could. Over the swell of her tummy she could see Renny’s thing pushing into her; his big testicles had climbed high, and she squashed down on them, making them stretch out the thin skin of his scrotum. She bumped

and ground on him, wanting him inside her, and wanting to hurt him at the same time.

When he brought his hand between her legs fanning his four fingers over her clitoris, then pushing his thumb up and mashing it, pressing it into her body and rolling its hard bulb around inside her folds, she came in less than a minute. Her hips rolling in clumsy circles, her head fell back. His dick flopped out of her and she heard it smack wetly on his own belly.

“Back in, back in, keep fucking me...”

Chin tucked down, she watched Renny grab that thing and stick it inside her again; she clapped her thighs together and right away spread her legs wide open again, wanting him to fuck her deep.

She planted her heels firmly down in the softness of the air mattress, making their bodies rock and zipping hot pleasure between her legs. She'd never been wetter in her life. Renny's cock was so large it should have been difficult to take him, but both of them were spritzing so much lubrication the insides of her thighs gleamed; Renny's stomach and pubic hair glistened with the moisture they'd both created. She reached back with her hands and grabbed his kneecaps, arched her back but pushed her pelvis and hipbones forward. Using her butt muscles and her thighs she began to bounce in his lap. The angle of his dick was out of this world, the thing deep and hard and that huge crabapple cock head punching pleasure into her G spot...



Natalie's ribs pressed out against her skin as she heaved and chugged breath. She was on her hands and her heels, her hips and ass thrusting up and down with Renny's cock deep inside her. She made no moans, no gasps; she was quiet, just the soft sound of her breath, her face frozen in an expression of shock. Like the pleasure was so great she couldn't believe it.

She was using Renny as an object; her nails dug into his kneecaps, her heels pushed down in the air mattress and her toes curled back as far as they would go, she thrust and thrust her soft tum-tum jiggling with the effort.

Then her quiet was broken. Beginning as a whisper, a chant emerged: “I’m coming, I’m coming,” over and over. And then to Renny: “Can you feel me coming...? Ah, can you feel it?”

Renny said, “You’re so fucking wet...”

“I can’t stop, ah, mm, I can’t stop coming...”

She blasted a hoarse gasp as she came and then began vocalizing. Shrieks and gasps, vowel sounds, then biting her lips. She bounced too high and Renny’s cock jumped out of her, falling back on his stomach—but he was quick to grab it by the base and point it for Nat to sink herself down on it again. Nelson could see as his cock had parted Natalie’s folds, her opening squirted a tablespoon of thick clear liquid. She was so horny, and Renny was too, their sexual lubrication was everywhere. When she was bouncing again, rivulets of wet ran down Renny’s shaft and gathered in Renny’s pubic hair.

Natalie was coming again already, riding a new wave on an ocean of pleasure, crying out and letting them know. “I’m coming, I’m coming, oh shit, oh God...”

Then she was collapsing, her arms losing strength and giving way suddenly. She brought her knees up and together, falling against Renny’s thighs and rolling to her side. Her ass cheeks shook and her thighs quivered. Her feet flexed, her toes going up then curling a tight grip. She wailed and moaned and had her hands pressed between her thighs.

Renny scooted to a sitting position, slapping her ass, digging a thumb into her cheek to spread her opening for them both to see.

Natalie moaned, “Deeper, deeper...”

“You want it deep?” Renny asked.

“I want it deep, I want it so deep...”

“Get on your knees,” he said, and Natalie buried her face into the pillows, her shoulders pressed down flat, arms clumsily folding underneath her, her ass pointing up in the air. Labia fat and engorged, the center of her flower was a yawning mouth desperate to be fucked. “Higher,” Renny said, as he got to his feet overtop of her. He put a palm between her shoulder blades and pressed down, got his feet near her waist, dick pointing straight down. He squatted, bending his knees, dropping his hips until every inch pushed deep inside Natalie until his balls squashed against her mound. Natalie cried out, getting what she wanted.

Renny fucked her like that forever. She was crying. Big dick deep-drilling; bouncing on his knees, his ass rising and falling like an oil derrick. His long, thick, drill pipe plunging deep inside his wife, pulling out squirts of clear sex juice.

Natalie kept orgasming; they came in surging waves. She babbled and cried and made fists in the sheets. Renny’s deep pounding was relentless, thriving off Natalie’s abundant vocal feedback. The air mattress bounced and rocked Nelson. His wife’s face twisted and contorted, she hissed and wailed, her shut eyes squeezed tears. The noises she made were incredible. She was loud; screeching sometimes, her vocalizations echoing in the small, hot space.

Nelson worked his way up to the pillows again, got a leg on either side of Natalie’s head. He stroked her hair while Renny continued to ream her. Sweat streamed his old roommate’s face and body. The room was becoming a sauna; the air thick and wet and reeking of sex.

Renny withdrew, plopped his organ over Nat’s bottom and mushed it around, giving her pussy a break. She moaned and panted from exhaustion. Her head rolled in his lap, the top of her head grinding over the underside of his erection. Her weak arms worked to unfold, her hands clawing up the insides of his thighs until her fingers hooked over his waistband. She tugged his pants down til they caught on his erection, the point of his dick making a pulled-taut tent out of the cotton. He held Natalie’s wrists, stopped her working.

She said, “Nelson, you’re so hard, let me—”

“No,” he said.

“No?” she asked, her right hand closing over his cock, her thumb stroking it over the material. Brows curled up, lips parted, Nat took a look of worry that he hated to see. It was funny earlier in the evening when he was secretly taunting her with Renny’s presence, but not anymore. Not now. This was serious.

He showed her a loving smile that relaxed those furrows in her brow, told her: “This is for you. Take it, Nat. We’ll worry about me later. Right now I want you on your back, getting what you need.”

“I don’t need anything,” she said, furrows returning.

“I need it,” he said. “Take it for me, show me how you love it, make me happy...”



She showed Nelson. Renny pushed her flat on the bed, Nelson scooted to sit on the floor above the pillows to watch. Renny lifted one of her knees higher, up to her shoulder, exposing her slit to him. He pushed his cock into her again, his knees out wide like an outrigger, hips running it in and out of her. It wasn’t long before he had her crying out. She closed her eyes but let Nelson see her face, let him see her expression as she took it. She came again. He pulled her hair, tangled his hands in it and reefed her head back. She cried out; it hurt, but she bellowed for Nelson’s benefit. Then he had her doggy-style again, curled over her back and his hands squeezing and mashing her breasts.

Renny told her to get on her back and she told him to fuck off. He said, “Get on your back, you whore.” She said, “Last thing I want is to see your face.” He fucked her harder; slapped her ass until her skin tingled.

They fucked like that for a long time. Nelson couldn't have the room any hotter. She and Renny were slick and dripping. Her hair hung in greasy tangles on the bedding. Renny's sweat dripped on her skin. The sheets clung to them.

Both of them finally collapsed on the bed, bouncing on it, Renny's sweaty body heavy on her back. She jabbed him with an elbow. “Get fucking off me.”

He grabbed her neck, squeezed her, tugged her til she was on her back and she threw out her elbow again, catching Renny's cheekbone. He slapped at her face, wrestled with her until he straddled her waist. She kicked and thrashed but he pinned her wrists above her head, face looming over hers. His cock was heavy on her chest, its wet weight sliding, the belly of it rubbing over her hard left nipple.

When he sneered she spat. He squinted, jerked his face away, loomed close again, and she was sure he would purse his lips and dangle a spit over her.

“Do it,” she threatened, “do it, spit on me, you horse-cock man-whore...”

But his lips didn't purse, they slackened, and he got closer and closer...

She clenched her teeth, hissed, “If you fucking try to kiss me I'll bite your tongue off...”

It made him smile and chuckle a low, mean groan. His hips swayed, his slick inner thighs working lower, passing over her hips now and down her thighs. His cock bristled through her sweaty pubic hair.

She said, “Just fuck me, just fuck me and make me come...”

With her thighs together, Renny wiggled his hips until his cock head settled in her hot delta. She tilted her pelvis, and he pushed himself into her again.

She was loose and lubed and so ready for it, but with her thighs together it was like he was putting it in the first time all over again, and she hollered, arched her neck, curved her back, and struggled her arms in his grip...



Natalie took Renny like that with her legs together, his legs trapping her while his cock reamed her from an awkward angle. Now she was really crying and complaining—but not stopping him. Her face was shut off, her head rolling back and forth, her mouth opening and closing. All the tendons and veins stood out on her neck. But it proved too much.

“Too big,” she cried, “You’re too big, it hurts...”

Renny kept himself inside her, lifted a leg, pushed a knee between her thighs and forced them apart. Then Natalie was opening her legs clumsily, her limbs not responding the way she wanted them to, and Renny was pushing on the backs of her thighs. He got her knees up to her armpits, took her ankles and jacked them right back to her ears, his hands gripping her Achilles tendons. Natalie’s vagina was exposed fully, pushed forward, engorged, probably pulsing with the stretching it had taken for almost forty minutes straight. Renny gave her the full monty now, withdrawing his cock till Nelson could see the flared lip of the head, then ramming it home almost to his pubic hair. Natalie wanted it, meeting his thrusts, rocking her hips to meet him in a dirty syncopation. Her opening sluiced juice around Renny’s girth and she cried undulating notes of the purest deepest passion. Nelson watched her fingers dig into her hamstrings, helping her unwanted lover to expose her most intimate space for a deep dick goring.

“Oh fuck, oh fuck,” Renny panted. Sweat dripped off his chin and splashed on Nat’s tummy and her breasts pushed forward and squeezed between her knees.

“I’m gonna come,” he grunted, “oh fuck, I’m gonna come...”

Nelson said, “Don’t come inside her, okay?”

“It’s coming, it’s coming,” he said, hips driving up and down now, working faster and faster.

Natalie panted, “Pull it out, pull it out and show it to me, show me your come...”

Renny’s face went tight, and he clenched his jaw; breath snorted through his nose and his face roared in red. Nelson was sure he was coming inside his wife. “Don’t come inside her, Renny...”

Renny was freight training her, skin glistening with sweat, Nat’s feet pushed to the air mattress behind her ears. But he suddenly bucked, hips jumping back.

Nelson watched where his cock came out of his Natalie, saw the big shining weapon stringing a long pearly rope from between her legs.

Natalie’s ankles were released and her legs jumped but she gripped them still. Renny scrambled up her body with his hand on his huge manhood, another white rope pulsing from his urethra and dropping on Nat’s sweaty tummy. He was stroking it, saying, “I’m going to jerk it right in your big yap, show me that tongue, show me that fucking razor tongue, I got something for it...”

And Nat complied. Nelson’s eyes widened to circles watching his wife open her mouth, push out her tongue, curling it til the tip touched the point of her chin.

Renny roared and jerked his cock, and it pulsed steady streams across his wife’s face. Across her chin, over her nose and making her eyelashes flutter, then he straddled her folded body higher, her pretty face framed between the backsides of her knees and he got the tip pulsing into her open mouth, splashing up against her palette and onto her tongue. He stroked and roared, pulsed, squeezed, stroked again; each time producing more semen in

waning amounts. Finally he squeezed it till his hand shook and then plunged it into Nat's open mouth where she happily sucked on it. He gently humped it into her, his hips working up and down, hands taking her legs now and Nat's hands free to stroke his arm and his cock, squeeze his balls.

Chapter 13

Renny collapsed next to her with a long, exhausted groan. His weight tossed her up on the mattress, and she stumbled over top of him now, Renny trying to put his hands on her to give her a hug but she pushed him away. She walked on her knees and hands, buck naked, to the coffee table. There was a two-liter bottle of cola and she grabbed it with both hands, took a drink, swished it around her mouth and spat it in a glass. Then she took another long drink and swallowed. Both Nelson and Renny watched her and when she was done, she belched and wiped her mouth with the back of her hand. She used a discarded T-shirt to dry her face.

Renny lay on his back now, putting his hands behind his head on the pillow, chest heaving with furious breaths. He watched with amusement, his big tool coming across a leg, glistening from her insides. He said, "That's kind of, huh, hoo, dramatic," his voice coming in breathy starts.

"You're so, hah, gross," she said, spitting again into the empty glass.

"You stuck your, hoo, tongue out."

Nelson eased himself off of the air mattress, rested his butt on the floor with his back against the cabin wall. He was wild-eyed, watching her. She turned her face away from him and covered up with her hands. They were hot and slick against her cheeks. She could smell Renny's cologne and semen.

She parted her fingers and peeped at them, Renny naked and spent, laying on the bed, and beyond him, her husband looking aghast, bug eyes staring her way... Renny was scratching his stomach now, head rolling around on the pillow with his eyes glazed and looking up at the ceiling. He said, "Holy shit, huh, I can't... can't get over that..."

"I can't either," she said.

“Ho, huh, shit,” Renny panted. He took a loose corner of the sheet, held his cock in one hand and dried it with the other. “Oh my God,” he kept saying, his voice coming in gasps. “Oh wow...”

“Oh wow,” she repeated morosely, flashes of what Nelson had just watched popping up in her mind’s eye.

Renny panted, “Top of the charts, Nat. Number one spot.”

Nelson cleared his throat, asked, “What’s that?”

Renny rolled his head on the pillow to regard him. “Top fuck, best fuck ever, God, Nelson, your wife is a fucking tiger.”

But Natalie was watching Nelson. He raised his eyebrows complacently at Renny’s news that she was a tiger. Nelson had been into it the whole time on the bed, but now it was over and it was done. All the pleasure had been squeezed from the moment and now they were left in the ugly aftermath.

With effort she brought her eyes to meet Nelson’s, sitting there watching her without an expression. She covered an arm over her breasts, rose to her knees and walked on them to get to the mattress again, her thighs trembling from the workout his old friend had just given her. She climbed over top of Renny, who was chuckling and squeezing her arm. She tugged it away from him, collapsed on the bed next to Nelson and held her hand out for him—her heart stopped in anticipation...

Without hesitation, he took it in both his hands and held it. Her heart blossomed in her chest, opened like a flower.

He said, “That was... wild...”

“It was wild,” she said in a quiet whisper.

Now Nelson wiped the sweat from her brow, doing it lovingly with care. He said, “Don’t go crazy but I think... Let me turn on a light...”

“What’s wrong?”

“Hold on,” he said, letting her hand go and rising. There was a tall standing lamp in the corner above the bed and he pulled its chain and turned the light on. She covered her eyes, felt bright inescapable shame now at what her husband would see on the bed. Her and Renny naked and sweaty...

But when she pulled on a sheet to cover herself, he stopped her.

“What is it?”

Nelson lay a hand on her knee and tried to part her legs but she resisted.

“What are you doing?”

“Nat, open your legs.”

“Why?”

“Please,” he said and put pressure on her knee. She let her legs part and now watched in the low wattage light as her husband kneeled beside the bed and peered to examine between her legs.

“What are you doing?”

“Don’t freak out, Nat, but Renny came inside you.”

“What...”

Renny said, “No, I didn’t...”

Nelson still peered between her legs, his face troubled. She had her legs open, knees up, hands on her breasts. She said, “Did he?...”

“I mean, what do you think, Nat, take a look...”

She peered between her legs, using the pads of her fingers to tug her opening higher; could see a line of semen draped and tangled through her pubic hair, and it lead right to her aperture.

She clucked her tongue, sighed, “Way to go, Renny.”

“I didn’t,” he said, rolling to his side and facing them, he peeked down between her legs. “I did? Like, maybe a little...”

Nelson was mad. “A little? Like a little is okay?”

“What?”

“What do you mean What? She’s not on the pill, Renny, I said don’t come inside her...”

“Well fucking bring me condoms next time you want me to fuck your wife, Nelson, what do you want from me...?”

“It’s fine,” she sighed, rubbing her forehead, but her husband was still mad.

Nelson said, “Or don’t come inside her. What is this, high school, you’re fucking twenty-eight years old now, you don’t know how to pull out?”

“I did pull out, Nelson.”

“Yeah, after you shot a load inside her...”

She said, “Nelson, don’t be vulgar...”

“What, Nat? You don’t think this is a big deal?”

“It was just a little, Nelson,” Renny said. “You don’t need to lose your shit...”



Nelson couldn’t keep his eyes off the thing Renny had fucked his wife with. Dark brown, huge, glistening from Nat’s excitement down near the base where he hadn’t wiped it; it was stiff still, poking out between his legs and

the huge head laying on the mattress, its black seeping eye winking at him. He'd been fine, but now he was jealous. The jealousy wouldn't have come, he didn't think, if his old housemate hadn't put genetic material inside his unprotected and fertile wife.

"You don't think I need to lose my shit?"

"She's not going to have my baby, Nelson, don't worry about it."

"Oh cool," he said, "Sure, just come inside her. It doesn't mean a thing. You know, you should be grateful, I offered up a lot to my hungry friend. I bring you out here, I'm hospitable, allow you to share the most amazing fucking thing in my life and I only ask one thing. It's not a crazy ask, out of politeness I shouldn't even need to ask, right?"

"I barely did."

"Dude, can you go now, please? You don't think I should lose my shit and I'm thirty seconds from doing it, it's best if you hop on out of here, okay?"

"Right. In the middle of the night. Hospitable? I gave you something. You're the one that's hungry..."

"Whatever. Take the snowmobile back to town. I'll pick it up tomorrow."

"At three in the morning? Dude, seriously, you're overreacting now. I'll freeze to death out there."

"Can you go, please?"

Renny looked to Nat, who seemed bewildered. She looked from him to Renny, said, "I guess... I don't know. You should do what my husband says."

"Guys, come on. It's so late, I'll sleep on the couch..."

"Go back to the bar, dude."

Nat said, “Take the snow machine out to the road and call a cab. You won’t freeze.”

“You’re on his side? After what we did?” He made a move like he would hold her hand and Natalie smiled like she thought it was funny, meeting Renny’s gaze but pulling her hand out of the way.

“Cold,” Renny said.

Nelson was losing his resolve, feeling like a jerk now, but the more he looked at that weapon his wife was in love with the more frantic he became about his old friend leaving. “Just go.”

“Real jerky thing to do, man,” Renny said, raising his eyebrows.

“Yeah, well, maybe, but maybe you don’t ejaculate inside my wife.”

Renny raised his palms, shaking his head at them. “Whatever. You guys are fucked in the head. Both of you. It’s literally no big deal, we could stay up and shoot the shit, go for round two, but you want to play hot shot for some reason.” He backed off the mattress, struggled to stand like he’d been wiped out from the fuck session he just had with Nat. His cock wagged and bounced between his legs, fading, but still huge and stiff. He and Natalie watched him pull his things on, struggle to tuck his cock in his tight jeans, zip up and grab his jacket. He stopped at the door. “Right? Last chance for you to come to your senses...”

He waited but Nelson said nothing. Inside his heart was hammering, and he wanted to tell him to stay. Somehow now seeing him standing there with the impression of his cock pushing out the denim got his lust firing up again. Round two? Round two could be hot. Yeah, and he wouldn’t mind having his own turn...

“Cool,” Renny said, “so I’m just going to take your keys...” Now he unhooked one of the snowmobile keys off the hook by the door, pausing, waiting for a reprieve... “And I’m going to take a snowmobile out to where? —the road? Call a cab and I guess I’ll see you dumb fucks next Christmas when you want a fucking stunt cock? Right, and I’m the asshole...”

Natalie said, “Those keys are for the machine we were on.”

Renny nodded. “And what’s the fucking road called? For the cab...”

Natalie said, “Country Route 9, or Old High Grove Road. We’re... what Nelson...?” She looked to him now “...1596?”

He nodded. Renny was cocky now, saying, “Well, whatever, Nat, I had a blast. You keep that little thing hairy and warm for me and I’ll give it a workout next Christmas. And I’m looking forward to it...”

He said, “Bye, Renny.”

Renny rolled his eyes, shook his head, cracked the door open. Cold and snow blasted in. “You take care, Nelson. You too, Nat...”

She said, “Bye, Renny...”

He blew her a kiss, tugged up the collar of his leather jacket and left, closing the door behind him.



Nelson rose now, his cock poking out the front of his boxer shorts, standing and looking out the window. She stood up with him, rubbed his shoulder. He covered her hand with his. They walked to the window together, seeing Renny sitting on the snow machine, the headlight on, exhaust pluming from it. He acquainted himself with the controls, looked up to the window to see them watching from the nice warm cabin. She resisted the urge to wave. Then he was revving it, getting the tracks going, working a tight circle, pointing it down the trail in the right direction before giving it some gas. They watched the taillight rise the crest of the hill, dip over the edge and

light up the conifers. Soon it faded, it went dark again, and he was gone. She stood naked alone next to her husband.

He said, "So what do we do now?"

"What do you mean?"

Nelson sighed, looking out the window and raking a hand over his hair, holding it back, clenching it at the top of his head. His expression was tight with concern. "I'm sorry he came inside you. He should have worn a condom."

She said, "He should have. I know he should have."

"Do we have to go to a pharmacy? Do we get a morning-after pill? I guess we should. I mean, I don't want to be those kind of people, and I don't like you taking it, but, I guess..."

"We don't have to, Nelson."

"You don't think you're ovulating?"

She shook her head, watching out the window but aware of her husband's dim reflection in the glass.

He said, "You don't look certain. Don't you want to be safe? I mean, I guess it's a little late to be safe. That's on me, too, Nat, I should have planned this better."

She looked at his profile. "You planned this?"

His mouth twitched. "Not at all," he said.

"Did you?"

He turned to look at her. "Did you cheat on me last year?"

Touché. She gave him back an unflinching face. "No."

Chin doing a slow nod, both of them agreeing the bad they'd done didn't exist, he said, "We're both good people who love each other to bits, Nat. We wouldn't do that."

"We wouldn't. I love you way too much, I mean, fucking cherish you, to do something that would hurt you."

He said, "And I have way too much respect for you to grandstand some crazy scheme of manipulation, wanting to see you go wild..."

She did a funny thing with her lips so she wouldn't smile, pursing them to a slim line and turning them inward. Nelson smiled a little too, but neither of them wanted it.

She stepped into his space and he put his arms around her, held her and made her feel safe. She kissed his bare chest.

Nelson kissed the top of her head, saying, "There's a pharmacy in High Grove, I wonder if they have morning-afters? We have like a day or something, right? Maybe it can wait till we get to the city where we know they'll have them. Ask in High Grove they might parade us down the street with sandwich boards that say we're heathens."

She said, "Take us out to a public flogging."

"Can't say we don't deserve it."

"We're bad."

He agreed. "We're really bad."

She bit on her lower lip, wondering why when something so wrong had just transpired she didn't feel frightened. She felt happy, felt safe, and more in love with her husband than ever.

She stepped back so she could see his face. "Nelson, I can't mean this more: I love you so much."

He smiled at her. "I love you, too, Nat. I love you so much."

“We don’t need a morning-after pill.”

“You’re confident?”

“I’m not ovulating.”

“I know your schedule, Nat. We’re near your period, maybe a week—how can you be sure?”

“Shit, Nelson, trust me, I’m sure.”

He looked at her with pursed lips, wishing he could be as sure as she was, trusting her anyway.

“It’s okay,” she said, holding his bare shoulders and locking eyes with him.

“I trust you,” he said, voice still tinged with worry.

She sighed, rolled her eyes up to the ceiling. “I wish there was a better way to do this.”

“Do what?”

“What I’ve been looking forward to all weekend.”

“What’s that?”

She patted his arms, gave him a shake. “Hold on,” she told him, walked to the other side of the couch where she had her bag, rummaged through it and found what she was looking for. She returned to him and presented it. A dark blue box with an ivory ribbon on it.

“Nelson Stacks, I do not need a morning-after pill.”

“Okay...” He eyed the box suspiciously.

She said, “I am not ovulating...”

“Okay...” He took the box from her.

She said, “Open it. Just pull the top up.”

She waited as her husband held the base of the box, pulled and tugged the ribbon and lid up and moved it away. He eyed what was inside, uncomprehending. A pair of knitted baby booties...?

She said, “I am—Nelson, my wonderful, fit, loving, and oh-so-devious husband—pregnant with your baby.”

Nelson’s eyes did a funny flutter thing before he collapsed against her, box tumbling from his hand to the floor, his kneecaps banging her thighs then dragging down her kneecaps. “Ow, hey, Nelson, Nelson, don’t you faint on me, baby, Nelson...”

She cradled him in her arms, his weight making them both sag. Nelson didn’t go down, he recovered, but she could tell by looking in his eyes he was woozy. They collapsed in the couch together and her husband was all over her, grabbing and hugging, that drowsy unconscious face lighting up again, eyes sparkling, cheeks stretching with a wide open smile.

“Are you... are you serious? Shit, I know, I know it—you’re fucking serious, oh God, Nat, oh my God...”

“Merry Christmas, buddy,” she said, brushing tears from her own eyes.

She thrust her arms around him and squeezed him with all her might and he hugged her back, treating her cautiously already. “Oh baby, oh Nat, oh, I’m going to be a dad...?...”

“You are, baby... you are...”

Chapter 14

He kissed her; transferred to her the love in his heart he felt. She gave it back. They rocked together on the couch, holding each other and feeling each other.

When it was quiet, and they'd stopped making their love sounds, he said, "If something happened last year between you and Renny, and I know it didn't, but if it did: say maybe I saw it happen; I just wish that if that were the case I would have found a way to tell you it was okay..."

She said, "I do too, wish you'd found a way..."

"If it happened."

"If it happened," she said.

"I wish I could've found a way or been brave enough at least to try to tell you how it made me feel..."

"I know, it's okay..."

He said, "But there wasn't a way..."

"It would be hard."

"It would be hard. How do you tell someone something like that? But I tried to show you. I tried to show you every day how much you mean to me."

"You did. And I showed you every day, too. This last year has been amazing..." Now she rubbed her tummy over where the life they'd created was beginning.

He hugged her again. "I couldn't love you more."

She laughed, eased from his clutch but held his hand. “I know. I feel it. And I couldn’t love you more, either.”

“I thought about it—if it happened—every day since...”

She made a funny face at him. She said, “I didn’t. I thought about how it made me feel about you...”

Now he smiled. “That’s where we’re different.”

“Not so different,” she said, looking a little more glum now. “I think that’s obvious...” Both of them looked at the bed at where it all happened tonight; they thought about it in different ways but they both lusted for it. She said, “I wish I could’ve told you. Could’ve told you—that if I did something like that, I wouldn’t be afraid to say the truth because you mean so much.”

He said, “Well, good thing it didn’t happen.”

“Right. It happened tonight though.”

“That was something we did together. And we both got what we wanted...”

She let his hand go and batted at his thigh like she was disgusted by his words.

He said, “You liked it...”

“I don’t know what gave you that idea,” she said, smirking and folding her arms like she was embarrassed.

Now he craned his neck to look out the window. He said, “The snow is really coming down.”

She turned as well, looking out at the fat flakes lit up by the porch light. “Wow, it is.”

“We were kind of mean to him.”

“He deserved it. But yeah, kind of mean. I was mean last year too—”

They both looked at each other and smiled. Nothing happened last year...

He said, “Do you think maybe I should call him?”

Now she was looking out the window again, scratching her neck. “Isn’t it like three in the morning? He’ll never get a cab to come out here.”

“What if he just tries to take that snow machine all the way to town?”

“He doesn’t even have a proper coat.”

“What an idiot. Fucking freezing out there, buy a damn parka, am I right? It’s winter...”

She laughed. “It is really cold.”

“I’m going to call him.”

“Okay. Christmas spirit and all.”

“That’s the idea, Nat.”

He circled his hand over her bare tummy, rose, went to his pants on the floor and withdrew his phone. He said to her, “But I need my turn.”

Her head fell back, and she made an exasperated sound. “I’m exhausted.”

“Believe me,” he laughed, “I won’t be long.”

He went through his contacts, found Renny’s name and tapped the call button.



She watched her husband, her scheming Machiavellian lover-boy, standing there with no shirt on, his gym-toned body glowing in the light from the window behind her. The room was warm; they had supplies in their den, and they had a lot of love. Her heart swelled in her chest. Something else swelled too; a life growing inside her, two months along now verified by Dr. Greenwald. A swirling baby Stacks that they would love and cherish forever together.

Nelson got Renny on the phone. She poured herself another Coke. It'd been tricky all weekend pretending she was drinking when she wasn't. Her bottle of single malt—which Nelson hated—was just iced tea. She let Nelson drink too much while she pretended.

She sat back and chugged half a glass, put her feet up on the table.

Nelson said, “Hey, buddy.... Glad I got you.... I know it’s fucking cold...” Now he laughed, walking in a circle with his head down, a smile beaming on his face. “I know, that’s why I’m calling.... No, you’re not going to be able to get a cab, probably.... Where are you?.... Well drive it back.... Yeah, I’m serious.... I’m sorry...” Now he was laughing again, dipping at the knees. “Yeah, Natalie says it’s okay.... I might have overreacted.... Okay.... Yes, I’ll crack a beer.... It’s already so hot in here... All right, all right, I’ll stoke it. Hey, guess what...” Nelson had wandered near the couch and he plopped down to sit right next to her with his body against hers. He put a hand on her knee. “Dude, we have something to celebrate.... Uh-huh, no.... Nat’s pregnant, dude.... Not from you, you idiot,” he laughed, his shoulders shaking. “You think she’s pregnant already from that? No, dude, she’s.... huh?.... Yes, I’m the father, asshole...” Now he turned to her, phone pressed to his chest, speaker side down. “I am the father, right?”

She made a fist at him and scowled, grabbed his cheeks and pouted his lips out. “You’re the father, you dumb ass.”

To Renny now he said, “Yeah, I’m the father, I checked.... Thanks, man.... yeah, thank you, I am, I am fucking excited.... See you in a few.... We’ll crack some beers...”

He closed off the call, tossed the phone to the table. "I feel better about that," he said.

She said, "We're good people. We're not so bad after all..."

Nelson patted himself on the back.

She said, "He's on his way back?"

"Yeah, he turned around already. He was out at the road."

"You've got enough time for your turn..." She gave him a sexy smile, let her knees part.

"Renny's coming back..."

"You said you wouldn't be long..."

He just stared at her, bouncing his eyebrows.

"What are you doing?"

He just bounced them again, wiggled them.

"Renny? Nelson, I'm not sleeping with him again."

He nodded, gave her a sure smirk.

"I'm not sleeping with him again, Nelson, you can forget it."

"Round two, Natty, round two..."

She laughed, batted his leg, saying, "Nelson, I'm not sleeping with him again, so you can stop smirking..."

He bumped her shoulder, kissed her lips.

"You're still smirking."

“I know, Nat, you hate him, you just hate him so much...”

“Nelson, I’m warning you to stop smirking at me. I will never, never, ever, ever sleep with Renzo Bulgarelli again.”

The room brightened with a headlight coming down the trail. They both looked up at the ceiling, knowing he would be there soon.

When she looked at her husband, he was still staring point blank. She folded her arms over her rubbery nipples and scowled. “Stop smirking at me, Nelson!”

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